



The Consulting Club

Faculty of Management Studies
University of Delhi

FMS

General Management Prep-book 2025



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Issue #1 2025

Issue 1
February 2025

The FMS General Management Prep-book issue of February 2025 documents the interview experiences of students across general management firms to assist the students of FMS Delhi and other business schools in their preparation for interviews during placements.

The aim of sharing these experiences is to inform students about the interview experiences of past batches and to help them prepare for their placements accordingly.

The experiences listed below are not necessarily the best way to handle interviews. They only serve to give students an idea as to what to expect when they walk into an interview. Every individual could have his/her unique way of tackling general management interviews, each of which could be correct.

This document has contributions from students who appeared for campus interviews conducted by general management firms during the placement process over the past years.

General Management Prep-book 2025
The Consulting Club, FMS Delhi

Issue 1
February 2025

The Club extends its gratitude to everyone who shared their cases and interview experiences, helping us create a comprehensive preparation resource for future batches.

We would also like to thank our entire batch for their efforts, as well as the senior batches for their support in compiling this prep-book. Their contributions have ensured a wide variety of cases, providing the reader with a thorough understanding of the types of cases they might encounter.

We are especially grateful to the alumni of the Consulting Club, FMS Delhi, for their valuable feedback, which has helped enhance the quality of this book. Finally, we would like to express our appreciation to the Faculty of Management Studies and its esteemed faculty for giving us this opportunity.

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(L-R): Rajat Sharma, Siddharth Dixit, Kotipalli Hemanth Harsha, Chehak Agrawal, Arvind Menon, Siddharth Singh, Sohum Gakhar



Top (L-R): Pranav Garg, Shruti Agrawal, Aditya Bhargav Arvind
Bottom (L-R) : Manushree Singh, Kavisha Bhatnagar, Shreya Chauhan

The Consulting Club is a student-run organization with the agenda of liaising with Global Consults to increase their presence at FMS Delhi, while working towards preparing the students for a career in consulting and general management. In addition to providing practical experience through workshops, guest lectures facilitation, the Club serves as the nucleus for pioneering strategy games and consulting projects and has developed a reputation for unmatched innovation, with activities spanning several spheres like Management Consulting, Risk Advisory, Process/Operations Consulting, IT Consulting, Benchmarking Advisory.

Our Mission: “Why We Exist?”

Build awareness & generate interest in the consulting and general mgmt. domain among students, create & maintain long-term corporate relationships with top firms of the world, and make available all resources necessary to build content and competency on campus.

**The Consulting Club
FMS Delhi**

We are excited to present the inaugural edition of the FMS General Management Prep-book for the academic year 2025. With this first edition, The Consulting Club aims to strengthen the foundation for General Management preparation, equipping students with the knowledge and skills required to excel in diverse leadership roles across industries.

This prep-book has been meticulously designed to help students navigate the rigorous selection process for General Management roles, covering key concepts, frameworks, and real-world scenarios. It provides structured insights into functional domains such as strategy, operations, marketing, and finance, ensuring a well-rounded preparation.

Building on valuable feedback and evolving industry expectations, this edition includes recent interview experiences, functional deep-dives, and cross-sectoral case studies, offering a holistic approach to preparation. We hope this prep-book not only helps you secure your ideal General Management role but also serves as a valuable resource throughout your career in business leadership.

Wishing you success in your preparation!

Best of luck!




Rajat Sharma
President

The Consulting Club, FMS Delhi

Meet Our Team: Consulting Club (2024-25)



Rajat Sharma

President



Arvind Menon



Chehak Agrawal



**Kotipalli Hemanth
Harsha**



Siddharth Dixit



Siddharth Singh



Sohum Gakhar

Executive Members



**Aditya Bhargav
Arvind**



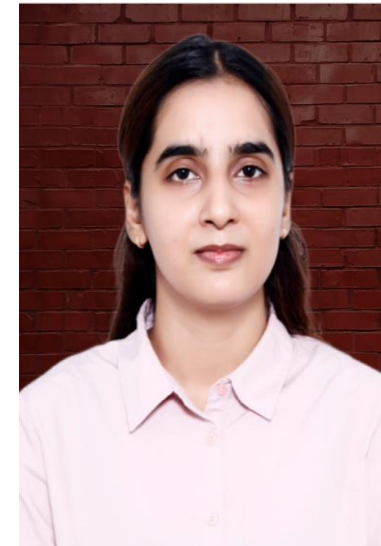
**Kavisha
Bhatnagar**



**Manushree
Singh**



Pranav Garg



Shreya Chauhan



Shruti Agrawal

Associate Members

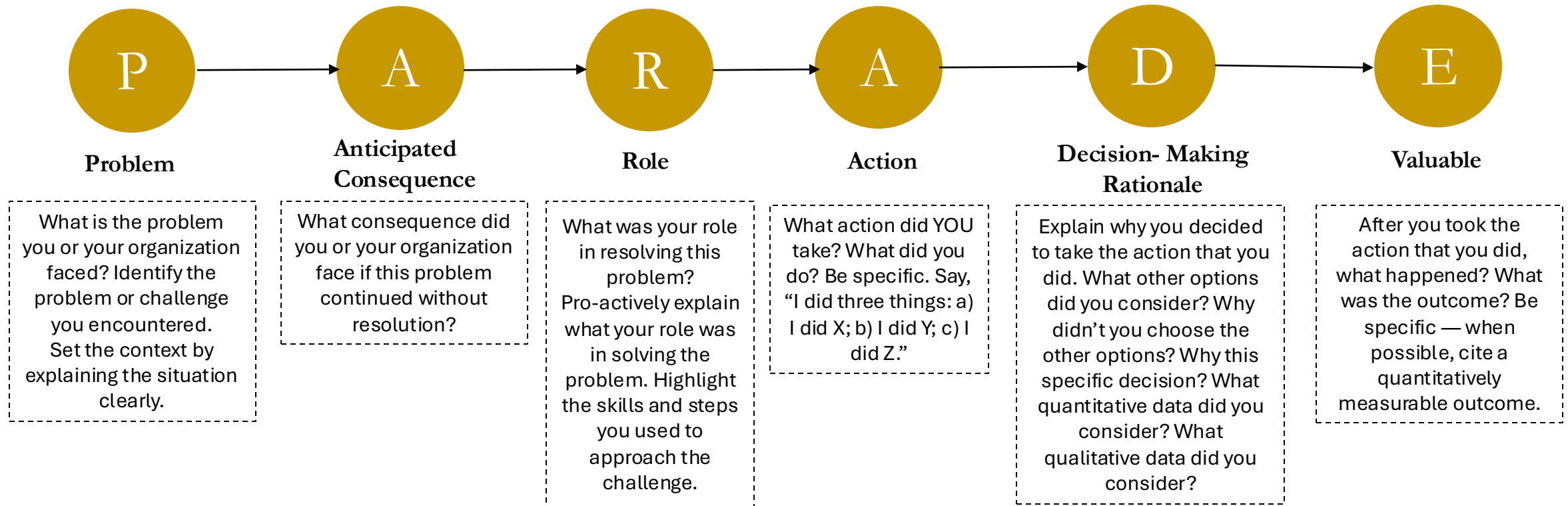
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Part A – Frameworks

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The **PARADE framework** is a behavioral interview technique used to structure answers in a coherent, impactful, and memorable way. It helps showcase your problem-solving skills, contributions, and results by focusing on key elements of a professional experience or accomplishment.



The STAR method is a useful tool for answering behavioral questions in interviews by describing the specific situation, task, action and result of the story being described.



Situation

Detail the background. Provide a context. Where? When?



Task

Describe the challenge and expectations. What needs to be done? Why?



Action

Elaborate your specific action. What did you do? How? What tools did you use?



Result

Explain the results: accomplishments, recognition, savings etc.

Example:



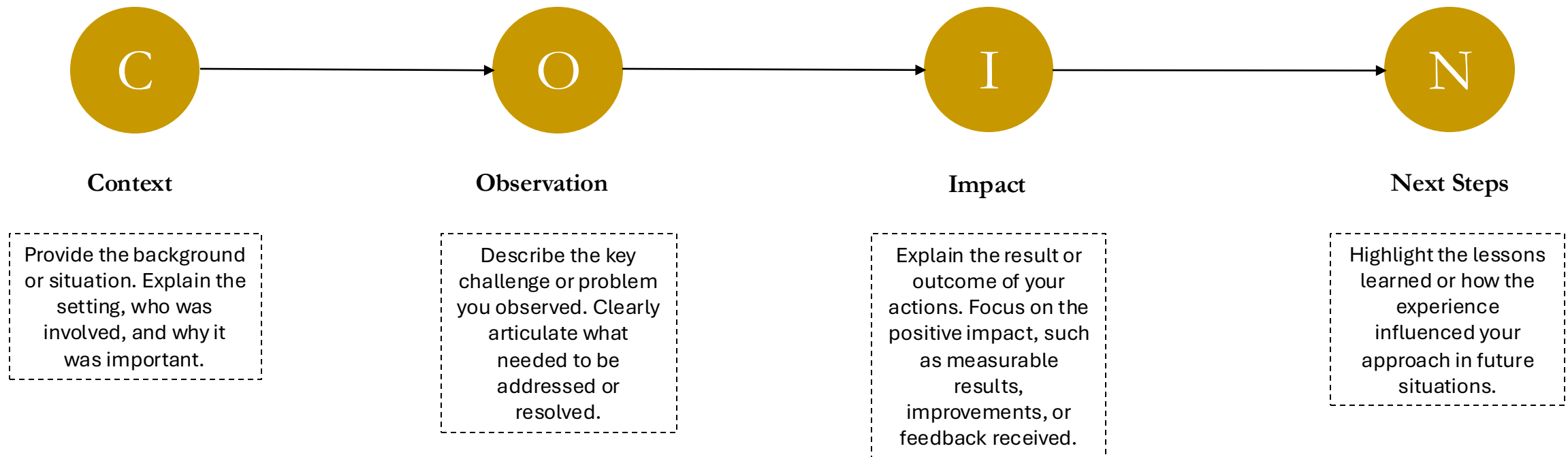
Situation (S): Advertising revenue was falling off for my college newspaper, *The Review*, and large numbers of long-term advertisers were not renewing contracts.

Task (T): My goal was to generate new ideas, materials and incentives that would result in at least a 15% increase in advertisers from the year before.

Action (A): I designed a new promotional packet to go with the rate sheet and compared the benefits of The Review circulation with other ad media in the area. I also set-up a special training session for the account executives with a School of Business Administration professor who discussed competitive selling strategies.

Result (R): We signed contracts with 15 former advertisers for daily ads and five for special supplements. We increased our new advertisers by 20% over the same period last year.

The **COIN framework** is best used for answering **behavioral**, **situational**, and **conflict-resolution** HR questions, where you need to showcase your ability to analyze a situation, address challenges effectively, and deliver impactful results while highlighting key learnings.



Part B – Company Compendiums

[Main Index](#)

Founded – 1988

Founder – Gautam Adani

M. Cap - \$ 32.86 Billion

Revenues - \$36 billion

Owned by – Adani Enterprises

Headquarters – Ahmedabad ,
Gujarat , India

Chairman – Gautam Adani

Operating with 10
publicly traded
companies and
46000+ employees.

Owned Companies - Adani Enterprises Ltd ,Adani Ports and SEZ Ltd
,Adani Green Energy Ltd , Adani Total Gas Ltd ,Adani Energy
Solutions Ltd and Adani Power Ltd

VISION : To be a world class leader in businesses that enrich lives and contribute to nations in building infrastructure through sustainable value creation.

CORE VALUES

- **Trust** – We shall believe in our employees and other stakeholders.
- **Commitment** - We shall stand by our promises and adhere to high standards of business.
- **Courage** -We shall embrace new ideas and businesses

CSR INITIATIVES

1.Adani Foundation: Established in 1996, the Adani Foundation focuses on education, community health, sustainable livelihood, and infrastructure development across India.

2.Education Initiatives: The Adani Vidya Mandir schools provide free education to underprivileged children, emphasizing quality education without tuition fees.

3.Community Health: The Adani Foundation runs mobile healthcare units and health camps in rural areas, offering medical services to underserved populations.

4.Sustainable Livelihood: Adani Group supports skill development programs that aim to empower youth and women through vocational training, enhancing employability in various sectors.

5.Swachhagraha: This initiative promotes cleanliness and hygiene through community engagement and awareness campaigns.

Founded – 1857 Founder – Ghanshyam Das Birla M. Cap - \$ 113 Billion Revenues - \$66 billion	Owned by – Birla Group Holdings Pvt. Ltd. Headquarters – Mumbai, Maharashtra, India Chairman – Mr. Kumar Mangalam Birla	Activities in 36 countries with 1,87,000+ employees, 180+ manufacturing units globally	Owned Companies – Aditya Birla Capital, Aditya Birla Finance Limited, Aditya Birla Money, Grasim, UltraTech Cement, Hindalco, Novelis Inc, Aditya Birla Fashion and Retail, Vodafone Idea, Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC Limited
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VISION : To be a premium global conglomerate with a clear focus on each of the businesses.

MISSION : To deliver superior value to our customers, shareholders, employees, and society at large.

CORE VALUES

- **Integrity** : Acting and making decisions in a fair and honest manner, upholding the highest standards of professionalism, and being recognized for doing so.
- **Commitment** : Building on the foundation of integrity, we do everything necessary to deliver value to all stakeholders.
- **Passion** : Fuelled by an energetic, intuitive zeal that stems from emotional engagement with the organization.
- **Seamlessness** : Collaborating and working together across functional groups, hierarchies, businesses, and geographies.
- **Speed** : Responding to both internal and external customers with a sense of urgency.

CSR INITIATIVES

1. **Aditya Birla Center for Community Initiatives and Rural Development**: Reimagining and reinventing 300 villages into model villages.
2. **Healthcare initiatives** : Around 10,000 children received support for diagnosis and treatment for several types of cancer. Around 8,000 girls received HPV vaccination to prevent cervical cancer.
3. **Education** : Implemented need-based infrastructure interventions like toilets, water stations, digital classrooms, libraries, etc. in over 333 Schools and 140 Anganwadis.

Founded – 1995
Founder – Sunil Mittal
M. Cap - \$75 Billion
Revenues - \$19 billion

Owned by – Bharti Enterprises
Headquarters – Vasant Kunj ,
 New Delhi , India
CEO & MD – Gopal Vittal

Leading ICT provider with a
 global network across the USA,
 Europe, Africa, Middle East,
 Asia-Pacific, and SAARC.

- In 17 Countries across Asia and Africa
- Top 3 mobile service providers globally
- Over 490 million customers across its operations
- 365,000+ RKMs in 50 countries and 5 continents

VISION :Our vision is to enrich the lives of our customers. Our obsession is to win customers for life through an exceptional experience.

CORE VALUES - We aim to work towards our vision, driven by our values of **AIR - Alive, Inclusive & Respectful.**

- **Alive** – We act with passion, energy, and innovation to fulfill customer needs.
- **Inclusive** – We embrace diversity and adapt to enrich the lives of our communities.
- **Respectful** – We value our customers, staying humble, open, and honest to build mutual respect.

AIRTEL COMPANIES



Airtel Thanks App



Airtel Xstream



Airtel Payments
Bank



Wynk Music

Founded – 1967
Founder – Serge Kampf
M. Cap - € 27.26 Billion
Revenues - €1.9 billion

Owned by – Capgemini SE
Headquarters – Paris ,France
CEO – Aiman Ezzat

Operates in 50+ countries with 340,000+ employees.

Industries : Aerospace and Defense ,Automotive ,Banking and Capital Markets,Consumer Products,Energy and Utilities,Healthcare,High-tech Hospitality and Travel,Insurance,Life Sciences,Manufacturing,Media and Entertainment,Public Sector,Retail,Telecoms

PURPOSE : "Unleashing human energy through technology for an inclusive and sustainable future."

CORE VALUES

- **Honesty** – Loyalty, integrity, uprightness, a complete refusal to use any underhanded method to help win business or gain any kind of advantage.
- **Boldness** - A flair for entrepreneurship, and a desire to take considered risks and show commitment (naturally linked to a firm determination to uphold one's commitments).
- **Trust** -The willingness to empower both individuals and teams; to have decisions made as close as possible to the point where they will be put into practice.
- **Freedom** - Independence in thought, judgment and deeds, and entrepreneurial spirit, creativity.
- **Fun** - Feeling good about being part of the company or one's team, feeling proud of what one does, feeling a sense of accomplishment in the search for better quality and greater efficiency, feeling part of a challenging project.
- **Modesty** -Simplicity, the very opposite of affectation, pretension, pomposity, arrogance and boastfulness.
- **Team Spirit** - Solidarity, friendship, fidelity, generosity, fairness in sharing the benefits of collective work; and accepting responsibilities and an instinctive willingness to support common efforts when the storm is raging.

Founded – 1857

Founder – Chandra Kant Birla

Privately Owned Company

Revenues - \$3 Billion

Owned by – C K Birla

Headquarter – New Delhi, India

Co-Chairman – Amita Birla

Operates in 20+ countries with 35,000+ employees.

Industries: Technology, Automotive, Home and Building, Healthcare

Companies owned: Birlasoft, NEI, AVTEC, Neosym, GMMCO, Orient Cement, HIL Ltd, Orient Electric, Orient Paper, CK Birla Hospital, Birla Fertility & IVE.

PURPOSE: “Drive sustainable growth, innovation, and long-term value creation across its businesses while maintaining a strong commitment to social responsibility, ethical practices, and employee well-being.”

CORE VALUES

- **Integrity & Ethics** – Conducting business with honesty, transparency, and strong ethical standards.
- **Customer-Centricity** – Focusing on delivering high-quality products and services to meet customer needs.
- **Innovation & Excellence** – Continuously improving and adopting new technologies for long-term success.
- **Sustainability & Responsibility** – Committing to environmental and social well-being through responsible business practices.
- **People-First Approach** – Investing in employees’ growth, well-being, and professional development.

CSR INITIATIVES

Healthcare – CK Birla Hospitals (CMRI, BMB, RBH, and BMCHRC) providing high-quality and affordable healthcare. Specialized initiatives to support patients for cancer & cardiac care, especially the underprivileged.

Education & Skill Development – Birla Institute of Technology (BIT Mesra) supporting higher education and research. Vocational Training Programs to enhance employability of youth through skill building initiatives.

Women empowerment & Community development – Programs focused on women’s health, self-employment, and financial literacy. Rural development initiatives supporting sanitation, clean water, and livelihood opportunities.



FMS



Dr.Reddy's

DR. REDDY'S LABORATORIES



The Consulting Club
Faculty of Management Studies
University of Delhi

Founded – 1967

Founder – Serge Kampf

M. Cap - € 27.26 Billion

Revenues - €1.9 billion

Owned by – Capgemini SE

Headquarters – Paris ,France

CEO – Aiman Ezzat

Drug discovery,
clinically-differentiated
assets and digital
healthcare

Over 200 products covering the whole spectrum of disease areas
spanning gastroenterology, oncology, pain management,
cardiovascular, dermatology, urology, nephrology, rheumatology and
diabetes. Brands include: Omez, Nise, Stamlo, Clamp, Ketorol,
Razo.

PURPOSE : "We accelerate access to affordable and innovative medicines because Good Health Can't Wait

CORE VALUES

- Integrity & Transparency– Conducting business with honesty, fairness, and accountability.
- Quality – Ensuring the highest standards in products and services.
- Reliability – Consistently delivering on commitments to patients and stakeholders.
- Innovation – Driving research and development to create better healthcare solutions.
- Sustainability – Focusing on long-term environmental, social, economic impact.
- Customer-Centricity – Putting patients and healthcare providers at the centre of all decisions.
- Collaboration & Respect – Encouraging teamwork, inclusivity, and respect for diverse perspectives.

CSR INITIATIVES

Health Education – Dr. Reddy’s Foundation Spreads awareness about health issues and preventive care.

Mobile Health Clinics – Providing free medical services to underserved communities and expanding access to life-saving drugs for patients globally through Rural Healthcare Programs and Affordable Medicines.

Education & Skill Development – DR. Reddy’s Foundation offers free education and vocational training programs for youth.

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2025

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Founded – 1982
Founder – Sajjan Jindal
M. Cap – \$26.6 billion (JSW Steel only)
Revenues – \$24 billion (FY24)

Owned by – O. P. Jindal Group
Headquarters – Mumbai
Chairman – Sajjan Jindal
CFO – Seshagiri Rao

India's leading private sector steel producer across 8 sectors with 55k employees

Subsidiaries - JSW Steel Ltd, JSW Energy, JSW Infrastructure, JSW Cement, JSW Ventures (Venture Capital Fund), JSW Paints
Sectors – Steel, Energy, Minerals, Infrastructure, Cements, Paints, Venture Capital, & Sports in multiple locations across India, U.S.A, Europe, and Africa

VISION: To bring positive transformation to every life we touch.

CORE VALUES

- **Commitment:** Commitment is the difference between success & failure. Staying committed in the face of adversity ensures the win. It builds trust & community.
- **Courage:** Overcome emotions that hold you back. Set out in uncharted waters & keep going till you reach your goal. Do the right thing even when you are not answerable to anyone.
- **Agility:** When change is the only constant, agility is the x-factor that defines success. Agility is to maneuver the uncertain, constantly re-think and reinvent. Agility is to be able to view change as an opportunity, not a threat.
- **Collaboration:** Together, we can do so much more than what can be achieved individually. Ideas take on new forms when transplanted into different minds. It's more fun to do things together, & it fosters growth & helps everyone win.
- **Compassion:** Each of us is unique. To not judge and to be able to show love and compassion is a form of real strength. After all we are part of one universe, which we need to make a better place for each one of us.

CSR INITIATIVES

- 1.JSW Foundation:** Social development arm of the JSW Group, committed to empowering rural communities through holistic interventions in education, health, skill development, environment, sports, and heritage conservation across 17 states and 38 districts in India.
- 2. Skill Enhancement:** 5000+ people skilled in various disciplines
- 3. Sports:** JSW has been able to train and sponsor several athletes from across the country, who have brought glory to India in Asian Games, CWG games and World Championships.
- 4. Health & Nutrition:** Their under-nutrition improvement program has helped over 31,000 young children and improved their overall health.
- 5. Agri-initiatives:** Benefitting 8500+ farmers
- 6. Arts, Culture & Heritage:** Renovation of India's heritage sites.

Founded – 1945
Founder – JC Mahindra , K.C Mahindra , Malik Ghulam Muhammad
M. Cap - \$ 37.5 billion (2025)
Revenues - \$ 16 billion

Owned by – Mahindra Group
Headquarters – Worli , Mumbai , Maharashtra
Chairman – Anand Mahindra
CEO & MD – Dr. Anish Shah

100 + Subsidiaries , across 20+ industries .
 8 listed (Tech Mahindra Limited, Mahindra & Mahindra Financial Services Limited, Mahindra Holidays and Resorts India Limited, Mahindra Lifespace Developers Limited, Mahindra Logistics Limited, Mahindra EPC Irrigation Limited, and Swaraj Engines Limited.)

Automotive



Farm Equipment



Technology Services



Hospitality



Financial Services



Renewable Energy



Logistics



Real Estate



Emerging industries & Equity Investments



Steel



PURPOSE : "Drive positive change in the lives of our communities. Only when we enable others to rise will we rise."

CORE VALUES

Good Corporate Citizenship -We will continue to seek long-term success in alignment with the needs of the communities we serve, without compromising on ethical business standards.

Professionalism -We support innovation and well-reasoned risk taking, seeking the best people for the job and giving them the freedom and the opportunity to grow.

Customer First -We will respond to the changing needs and expectations of our customers speedily, courteously and effectively.

Quality Focus- We make quality a driving value in our work, in our products, and in our interactions with others.

Dignity of the Individual - Through all our actions, we nurture fairness, trust, and transparency. We will value individual dignity, uphold the right to express disagreement;

Founded – 1973
Founder – Dhirubhai Ambani
M. Cap – \$197.4 billion
Revenues – \$120 billion (FY24)

Owned by – Mukesh Ambani (51%)
Headquarters – Mumbai
Chairman & MD – Mukesh Ambani

India's largest pvt. sector corporation, 3rd most profitable company, and 2nd largest by mcap and revenue. 155th on global Fortune 500.

Subsidiaries – Reliance Jio, Reliance Retail, Reliance Petroleum, JioSaavn, TV 18, Jio Payments Bank, Network 18, Hathway, DEN Networks
Sectors – Energy, Petrochemicals, textiles, natural resources, retail, & telecom

VISION: Aims to conduct businesses ethically and in a manner that is respectful to all. Reliance achieves this by aligning goals with six core values.

CORE VALUES

- Customer Value
- Ownership Mindset
- Respect
- Integrity
- One Team
- Excellence

CSR INITIATIVES

1. **Environment Protection Drives:** Environmental impact assessment and qualitative risk analysis are central to all our new projects. We have converted acres of arid lands into major green zones.
2. **Women & Youth Empowerment Programs:** Reliance nurtures and sponsors many projects designed to educate, employ and empower women and youth in and around the catchment areas of its operations.
3. **Reliance Community Development Programs:** Reliance conducts several livelihood training programs and has provided aid and equipment to the physically challenged
4. **Project Jagruti:** A project to uplift and bring dyslexic students from the underprivileged segment into the mainstream.
5. **Reliance Dhirubhai Ambani Protsahan Scheme:** A scheme for supporting meritorious students and providing financial aid to the toppers for pursuing higher studies in engineering and medical streams.

			
Founded – 2011 Founder – Sumant Sinha M. Cap – \$2.42 billion Revenues – \$620 million (FY23)		Owned by – Renew Energy Global PLC Headquarters – Gurgaon Chairman & CEO – Sumant Sinha	
		Decarbonization solutions company. First Indian renewable energy company to be listed on NASDAQ. Renewable asset base of 13.4 GW across 9 states.	Subsidiaries – Renew Akshay Urja, Renew Energy Markets, Renew India, Koppal-Narendra Transmission, Renew Wind Energy, Renserv Global, Renew Fazilka Solar Power, Renew Sun Waves, Gadag Transmission Sectors – Wind/Solar energy, Hydropower, Green Hydrogen
VISION: To be a global leader of the clean energy transition			
CORE VALUES Pioneer: Encourage creative and inspirational ideas, take bold calls, and respond to change in an agile manner to deliver sustainable future value. Responsible: Care for the planet, prioritize safety and deliver high-quality ESG-compliant solutions to clients with the highest ethical and governance standards. Excellence: Take charge and dive deep to build the best in class and deliver on time consistently by inculcating past learnings and embracing continuous improvement. Partner: Connected by trust and mutual respect, transcend boundaries and foster community-level collaboration across businesses and levels, by placing collective success over individual achievements.			
CSR INITIATIVES Waterless robotic cleaning: Through this initiative ReNew has been able to save 216,533 Kiloliters of water in 2021-22 which is approximately 200 times higher compared to 2020-21. Water conservation for communities: ReNew has implemented an effective community-based water management project in Jaisalmer district, Rajasthan, to address the challenges faced by the local population due to water scarcity. The project has empowered the local community to take charge of their own water management Joining forces responsibly with suppliers: ReNew has taken a comprehensive approach to integrating sustainability into its value chain by engaging its suppliers and service providers in the organization's sustainability efforts. To de-risk its supply chain of environmental and social hazards, ReNew assessed its supply chain management from an ESG perspective. Digital analytics for condition-based cleaning: ReNew has identified module cleaning as one of the major operational activities at its solar PV plants. The conventional time-based cleaning approach was inefficient and led to unnecessary water consumption. They aimed to develop a model to clean panels based on dirt deposition conditions. The use case led to an increase in the yield of plants from 0.5% to 0.8%, in addition to the water savings, without incurring any additional capex.			
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Founded – 1868

Founder – Jamsetji Tata

M. Cap - \$ 365 billion (Mar 24)

Revenues - \$ 165 billion

Owned by – Tata Sons

Headquarters – Bombay House,
Mumbai

CEO – N. Chandrasekaran

30 companies

across ten verticals,
28 publicly-listed
Tata enterprises

- Each Tata company operates independently under the guidance and supervision of its own board of directors and shareholders.
- Most valuable and recognizable brand from India.
- **Verticals:** IT, Steel, Automotive, Consumer Retail, FS, Infra, Aerospace & Défense, Tourism, Telecom and Media, Investment

IT



Financial Services



Infrastructure



Steel



Travel & Tourism



Telecom & Media



Trading & Investment



Motors



Aerospace & Défense



Consumer & Retail



MISSION : "To improve the quality of life of the communities we serve globally, through long-term stakeholder value creation based on Leadership with Trust"

CORE VALUES

Tata has always been value-driven. These values continue to direct the growth and business of Tata companies. The five core Tata values underpinning the way we do business are:

- **Integrity:** We will be fair, honest, transparent and ethical in our conduct; everything we do must stand the test of public scrutiny.
- **Excellence:** We will be passionate about achieving the highest standards of quality, always promoting meritocracy.
- **Unity:** We will invest in our people and partners, enable continuous learning, and build caring and collaborative relationships based on trust and mutual respect.
- **Responsibility:** We will integrate environmental and social principles in our businesses, ensuring that what comes from the people goes back to the people many times over.
- **Pioneering:** We will be bold and agile, courageously taking on challenges, using deep customer insight to develop innovative solutions.

Part C – Group Discussion(s)

[Main Index](#)

In case-based group discussions, participants are usually presented with a business scenario to analyze, which may involve HR issues, declining profits, market entry strategies, or operational challenges. The objective is to propose actionable solutions within the allotted time, taking into account both short-term and long-term impacts.

Time: Usually, 20-25 minutes are allotted for the discussion.

Rules:

1. Generally, includes 8 participants.
2. The case is repeated twice for clarity

Understanding the Case (2-3 minutes):

1. Identify the key facts, stakeholders, and problem statement.
2. Determine if the case focuses on strategy, marketing, operations, HR, or finance.
3. Take quick notes to outline your thoughts.

Opening the Discussion (3-5 minutes):

1. One person (preferably you) should briefly summarize the case in 1-2 minutes.
2. Define the core problem or decision point clearly.
3. Suggest a framework to analyze the case (e.g., SWOT, PESTLE, 4Ps, Porter's Five Forces)

Analysis & Discussion (10-15 minutes):

Key Objective: Deep dive into the case, analyze different perspectives, and propose solutions.

1. Break the problem down using relevant frameworks.
2. Balance qualitative and quantitative aspects—use logic, business sense, and data if available.

Frameworks that can be used: *SWOT Analysis, Financial Feasibility, Market and Customer Analysis, Operational Challenges, Risk Assessment, etc.*

Solution & Consensus Building (5 minutes):

Key Objective: Narrow down to a feasible, practical, and impactful solution.

1. Compare multiple solutions and weigh the pros and cons.
2. Aim for a collaborative consensus—agreeing on a balanced approach is better than forcing one idea.

Conclusion & Summary (2-3 minutes):

Key Objective: End with a structured summary and actionable recommendations.

1. Restate the problem and key insights derived from the discussion.
2. Summarize the chosen solution and explain why it is the best option.
3. Suggest implementation steps and risk mitigation strategies.

Example Questions and Sample Responses:

Q: XYZ Company, a well-established brand in the consumer electronics sector, has been facing **declining sales** over the past two years due to increasing competition from both global and domestic players. As business consultants, your team is tasked with analyzing the situation and recommending the best approach for XYZ Company.

Example Opening Statement: *"The case discusses XYZ Company facing declining sales due to increasing competition. The key stakeholders are the company leadership, employees, and customers. The problem requires us to decide whether XYZ should focus on cost-cutting or invest in a new market. We can analyze this using a SWOT framework to assess internal strengths and external opportunities."*

Example Closing Statement: *"To summarize, we analyzed XYZ Company's challenges using a SWOT framework. We considered both cost-cutting and market expansion but found expansion to be the more sustainable solution. Our recommendation is a phased market entry approach, supported by digital marketing and operational efficiency improvements. This balances revenue growth with cost control, ensuring long-term success."*

In an Abstract GD, the topic provided is often open-ended, philosophical, or metaphorical. The purpose is to assess your creativity, lateral thinking and ability to relate abstract concepts to business scenarios. These discussions can cover a wide range of interpretations, encouraging participants to think outside the box.

Time: Typically, 15-20 minutes.

Rules:

1. The abstract topic is presented, and participants are given 1 minute to organize their thoughts.
2. Generally, 6-10 participants.
3. The goal is to provide interpretations, examples and perspectives, relating them to real-world scenarios wherever possible.

Understanding the Topic (2-3 minutes)

Key Objective: Decode the abstract meaning of the topic.

1. Think about different interpretations: literal, philosophical, business, social, & technological aspects.
2. Start by explaining what the abstract topic means to you. This helps to set a direction.

Opening the Discussion (3-5 minutes):

1. Provide multiple perspectives in order to set the tone, depicting versatility in thinking.
2. Start with a general definition of the topic and then explain different angles of the topic.

Discussion and Idea Building (6-8 minutes):

Key Objective: Analyse the topic deeply and present logical arguments for the same.

1. Encourage free flow of ideas but at the same time structure your arguments.
2. Try to connect abstract topics to current trends in management, showcasing ability to bridge conceptual thinking with practical application.
3. Encourage others to share their perspective while keeping your contributions balanced.

Conclusion and Consensus (5 minutes):

Key Objective: Summarize key takeaways and reach a final viewpoint.

1. Weave together everyone's interpretations. Bring in the key points and offer a reflective conclusion.
2. Aim for a collaborative consensus—agreeing on a balanced approach is better than forcing one idea.

Example Questions and Sample Responses:

1. Abstract GD Question: "A Journey without a Destination"

Possible Arguments:

1. Philosophical Perspective: Life is about experiences, not just end goals.
2. Business Perspective: Startups and innovation thrive on continuous learning, not fixed outcomes.

Response from a Business Perspective: *"In the business world, many companies begin without a fixed destination. Startups like Google and Amazon started as small projects and evolved into industry leaders by continuously adapting. Their journey was never about reaching a single destination but about innovation and growth."*

Counter: *"While the journey is important, a lack of direction can lead to aimlessness. Businesses need goals, and people need objectives to stay motivated. So, perhaps, a balance between having a direction and enjoying the journey is the best approach."*

2. Abstract GD Question: "Black or White?"

Possible Arguments:

1. Philosophical Perspective: Life is not just black and white; it has shades of gray.
2. Social Perspective: Stereotypes and rigid thinking limit progress; inclusivity and diversity matter.

Response from a Social Perspective: *"Society often labels things as good or bad, right or wrong. However, social progress happens when we break these rigid notions. For example, gender roles and career choices are evolving, proving that life is not just black or white."*

Counterpoint & Debate: *"While flexibility is important, certain situations do require clear black-and-white decisions. Ethics in business, for instance, must have firm boundaries—fraud or corruption cannot have 'gray areas.' So, it's important to know when to be flexible and when to stand firm."*

A **Gamified GD** is a unique type of group discussion where elements of gameplay are incorporated. Instead of a traditional discussion format, participants engage in **problem-solving, role-playing, simulations, or tasks** to assess their **teamwork, leadership, analytical thinking, and decision-making**.

Time: Usually, 20-30 minutes are allotted for the discussion. (Depending on complexity)

1. Setup:

- Each participant is given chits, with each chit containing clues, hints, or background information relating to a larger scenario or mystery.
- The goal is to collaboratively use the clues provided to solve a puzzle, uncover a mystery, or complete the story.

- Key Objective:** The group must collaborate to piece together the hints in their chits, discuss the clues, and work towards a unified conclusion.

Introduction and Understanding the Brief (5-6 minutes)

Key Objective: Decode the analyze the hints given via chits to better understand the case.

- Understand the hints given to you and analyze the information and think about how they might connect with other pieces of the story
- Share your hints strategically to drive the discussion meaningfully.

Team Strategy and Discussion (12-15 minutes):

- Discuss possible strategies, plans, or solutions to accomplish the objective at hand.
- Encourage group collaboration. Try to piece together the information of the puzzle as a team.
- Actively listen and look for patterns and connectors to tie the information together.
- Recap regularly to ensure consistency of information.

Conclusion and Consensus (5-7 minutes):

Key Objective: Summarize key takeaways and reach a final viewpoint.

- Try to summarize the key points discussed in the discussion, to ensure nothing is missed and all points are covered
- Provide a logical explanation for the solution basis the evidence and hints.

Example Gamified GD Scenario:

Scenario: "The Supply Chain Breakdown"

Plot: A leading e-commerce company, QuickKart, is facing a massive disruption in its supply chain due to a cyberattack on its warehouse management system. The company processes over 1 million orders daily, and any delay could result in significant revenue loss and reputational damage. The IT security team is investigating the breach, but meanwhile, QuickKart's senior management must decide on an immediate action plan to ensure minimal disruption. Each participant holds critical pieces of information that can help the group solve the crisis and implement an emergency response.

Objective: The team must work together to identify the cause of the breakdown, mitigate the damage, and restore operations.

Hint 1 - "The cyberattack occurred at **3:00 AM**, targeting the central inventory database."

Hint 2 - "Multiple suppliers have reported **delayed payment processing**, causing disruption in raw material supply."

Introduction Example: "Based on the clues we have so far, it appears that the cyberattack happened during non-peak hours, potentially targeting QuickKart's core inventory system. This could mean that our stock data is compromised, leading to incorrect order fulfillment. We need to assess the extent of the issue and find alternative solutions to ensure smooth deliveries."

Conclusion Example: "After analyzing the clues, our group has identified that the cyberattack targeted QuickKart's inventory system, disrupting both supplier payments and order processing. Our short-term solution involves rerouting deliveries through alternative warehouses and manually processing urgent orders. In the long term, we recommend enhancing cybersecurity protocols and diversifying supply chain dependencies to prevent future disruptions."

Part D – Group Discussions Tips & Experiences

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Chairman of the Panel

1. Unlike TAS GDs, the **chairman has to contribute** and guide more actively.
2. Chairmen may be **voluntary**, and may not be rotated amongst the panel.
3. Provide a clear and detailed framework in the introduction, and try to ensure there are enough dimensions for everyone to be able to make an entry.
4. Mention major ideas in the conclusion.
5. Pick cases where you are confident of your ability to provide a structure.

Depth & Clarity

1. Take a methodical approach
2. Delve deeply into the problem
3. Articulate your points thoughtfully
4. Only make an entry when you **say something that adds value** to the discussion.
5. Think from multiple perspectives.

Structure & Demeanor

1. Mahindra GDs are different from Marketing GDs. They are **looking for practicality and a structure** similar to those used in consulting.
2. Maintain a professional & composed demeanour.

Hygiene Checks

1. Do not interrupt anyone.
2. Reread the case and think through your answer before making an entry.
3. Don't look at the evaluators during the GD.

Agricultural Equipment Manufacturer & Bad Monsoon Impact

Panelist 1: Welcome, everyone. Today's topic is, "An agricultural equipment manufacturer is facing challenges due to a bad monsoon." Let's structure our discussion by identifying the challenges posed by the bad monsoon, exploring immediate solutions for mitigating its impact, and suggesting long-term strategies to build resilience. Let's begin.

Panelist 2: The immediate challenge is the reduced purchasing power of farmers, as a bad monsoon directly affects crop yields and income. This will likely lead to lower demand for agricultural equipment.

Panelist 3: Adding to that, logistical challenges such as disrupted supply chains could further hinder sales. Dealers in rural areas might face difficulty in maintaining inventory.

Panelist 4: My colleague's point is valid, but another critical issue is the perception of agricultural equipment as a non-essential expense during financial stress. Farmers might prioritize essentials over machinery.

Panelist 5: Lastly, bad monsoons often highlight a lack of awareness among farmers about equipment that can help mitigate such challenges, such as irrigation or water-saving technologies.

Panelist 6: To address reduced purchasing power, the company could introduce flexible financing options, such as zero-interest loans or extended payment plans, to make equipment more accessible.

Panelist 7: Their colleague's point is practical. Additionally, launching a targeted marketing campaign to promote the benefits of water-saving and irrigation equipment could create demand despite the bad monsoon.

Panelist 3: Building on that, partnering with government schemes or NGOs to subsidize essential equipment could help both farmers and the company. This ensures affordability while driving sales.

Panelist 2: In the short term, the company could also provide support to dealers by offering extended credit or discounts to help maintain inventory and ensure supply continuity.

Panelist 1: Flexible financing options seem immediately feasible, especially if the company collaborates with financial institutions. However, the terms must be carefully designed to minimize risk.

Panelist 4: I agree, and I'd emphasize the importance of targeted marketing. Digital platforms can be leveraged to reach younger farmers, while traditional methods like field demonstrations can engage others.

Panelist 6: Partnering with government schemes, as suggested earlier, could be a long-term solution. However, it requires navigating bureaucratic processes, so it's important to have a dedicated team for such collaborations.

Panelist 7: Supporting dealers with credit extensions is feasible in the short term, but the company must monitor cash flow closely to avoid financial strain.

Panelist 3: To summarize, we identified reduced purchasing power, logistical challenges, and lack of awareness as key issues caused by the bad monsoon. Proposed solutions included flexible financing options, targeted marketing campaigns, partnerships with government schemes, and dealer support initiatives. A combination of these measures, implemented strategically, will help the company navigate current challenges and build long-term resilience. Great discussion, everyone!

EV Company Entering the Sector

Panelist 1: Welcome, everyone. The topic for today's discussion is, "Should an EV company enter the sector?" Let's structure our discussion by analyzing the opportunities and challenges of entering the sector, assessing the feasibility of the decision, and proposing strategies for a successful entry. Let's begin.

Panelist 2: One major opportunity is the growing demand for electric vehicles due to increasing environmental awareness and government incentives. This sector is poised for rapid growth.

Panelist 3: I agree with my colleague. However, the challenge lies in the high initial investment required for R&D, manufacturing, and establishing a robust supply chain.

Panelist 4: Another opportunity is the potential for innovation. EV companies can differentiate themselves by focusing on unique features such as longer battery life, faster charging, or advanced safety systems.

Panelist 5: Building on that, the competition in the EV market is intense, with established players having a significant advantage. Entering the sector requires a clear value proposition to stand out.

Panelist 6: From a feasibility perspective, entering the sector is viable if the company can leverage existing technologies or form strategic partnerships to reduce costs and accelerate market entry.

Panelist 7: Their colleague's point is valid. Additionally, conducting a detailed market analysis to identify underserved segments, such as affordable EVs for rural areas, could enhance feasibility.

Panelist 3: I'd also emphasize the importance of building an ecosystem. Investing in charging infrastructure or collaborating with energy providers can address customer concerns and improve adoption rates.

Panelist 2: To mitigate financial risks, the company could explore phased entry, starting with a limited product line or specific regions before scaling up operations.

Panelist 4: A key strategy is to focus on a niche market initially. For example, targeting urban commuters with compact, affordable EVs can help establish a foothold.

Panelist 5: Another approach is prioritizing sustainability and branding the company as environmentally conscious. This aligns with consumer preferences and strengthens brand equity.

Panelist 6: Partnering with governments and institutions to take advantage of subsidies and incentives is crucial. These can significantly offset initial costs and encourage faster adoption.

Panelist 7: Lastly, investing in after-sales service and customer education about EV benefits and maintenance can build trust and enhance the overall customer experience.

Panelist 5: To summarize, we discussed the opportunities in the EV sector, such as growing demand and innovation potential, along with challenges like high investment and intense competition. Proposed strategies included targeting niche markets, forming strategic partnerships, leveraging government incentives, and investing in infrastructure and customer education. A phased and strategic approach can ensure a successful entry into the EV sector. Excellent contributions, everyone!

Flight Delay & Brand Reputation Damage

Panelist 1: Welcome, everyone. The topic we are discussing is, "A flight delay has caused damage to the company's brand reputation. How should the company deal with it?" To ensure a productive discussion, let's address this in three parts: first, identifying the causes and immediate impact; second, proposing short-term solutions; and third, developing long-term strategies to prevent such incidents in the future. Let's begin.

Panelist 2: The primary issue is the immediate dissatisfaction of passengers due to delays, which likely leads to negative reviews and complaints on social media. This can quickly escalate, tarnishing the brand's image.

Panelist 3: I agree with my colleague. Another aspect to consider is operational inefficiencies, such as poor communication or scheduling conflicts, which may have caused the delay. Identifying these internal issues is crucial.

Panelist 4: Building on that, the lack of proactive communication during the delay could have worsened customer frustration. Passengers value transparency, and failing to provide timely updates exacerbates the situation.

Panelist 5: Additionally, frequent delays might indicate systemic issues, such as overbooking, staff shortages, or maintenance delays, which need to be addressed to avoid recurring problems.

Panelist 6: In the short term, the company should issue a public apology and offer compensation, such as vouchers or discounts, to affected passengers. This demonstrates accountability and helps rebuild trust.

Panelist 3: My colleague's suggestion is valid, but I'd also recommend implementing a robust communication system to provide real-time updates during delays. This keeps passengers informed and reduces frustration.

Panelist 7: Another immediate measure could be to deploy additional staff at the airport to assist passengers with rebooking and queries. Personalized attention can significantly mitigate negative experiences.

Panelist 4: For the long term, the company should conduct a thorough review of its operations to identify bottlenecks causing delays. Investing in better technology for scheduling and maintenance could reduce such incidents.

Panelist 2: I'd also suggest launching a customer education campaign highlighting the measures being taken to improve punctuality. This shows a commitment to improvement and can help restore brand image.

Panelist 1: Offering compensation, as mentioned earlier, is a practical short-term measure. However, it's essential to set clear criteria to avoid financial strain while ensuring fairness.

Panelist 5: I'd like to emphasize the importance of proactive communication. A dedicated app or text-based system for real-time updates is cost-effective and aligns with passenger expectations.

Panelist 6: Long-term measures, such as operational reviews and technology upgrades, are vital but require significant investment. The company should prioritize these based on the frequency and causes of delays.

Panelist 7: Lastly, improving staff training to handle such situations more effectively is a relatively low-cost measure with high impact. This ensures passengers feel cared for, even during disruptions.

Panelist 4: To summarize, we identified key issues, including customer dissatisfaction, communication gaps, and operational inefficiencies. Short-term solutions proposed include public apologies, compensation, and enhanced communication systems. Long-term strategies involve operational reviews, technology upgrades, and customer education campaigns. Implementing these measures holistically will help restore trust and prevent future incidents. Excellent discussion, everyone!

Declining Motorcycle Sales

Panelist 1: Welcome, everyone. Today's topic is, "Motorcycle sales are falling, give a solution." Let's approach this by identifying the possible reasons for declining sales, proposing solutions, and evaluating their feasibility. Each of us will contribute, so let's begin.

Panelist 2: A major reason for falling motorcycle sales could be the shift in consumer preferences toward electric vehicles. Rising fuel costs and increasing environmental awareness are likely influencing this trend.

Panelist 3: Adding to that, economic factors such as reduced disposable income or higher interest rates on loans may also deter potential buyers. Motorcycles are often considered discretionary purchases for many consumers.

Panelist 4: Another factor could be increasing competition from public transport and ride-sharing options. These alternatives are often more convenient and economical for urban commuters.

Panelist 5: Building on what my colleague mentioned, inadequate marketing efforts might also be a contributor. If the target audience isn't being reached effectively, sales will naturally decline.

Panelist 6: One solution is to invest in R&D for electric motorcycles. This aligns with current market trends and addresses environmental concerns while maintaining the brand's relevance.

Panelist 7: Their colleague's suggestion is valid, but I'd also recommend introducing attractive financing options, such as lower interest rates or extended payment plans, to make motorcycles more affordable.

Panelist 2: To counter competition from public transport, the company could focus on promoting motorcycles' flexibility and cost-efficiency for both urban and rural areas. Tailored marketing campaigns could help achieve this.

Panelist 5: Additionally, launching exchange programs where customers can trade in old motorcycles for discounts on new models might incentivize purchases.

Panelist 3: Developing electric motorcycles, as suggested earlier, is a long-term strategy. However, it requires significant investment and time to implement, so it should be balanced with short-term measures like targeted marketing.

Panelist 1: Financing options and exchange programs seem immediately feasible. They can be rolled out with minimal delays and are likely to have a direct impact on sales.

Panelist 4: My colleague's point about tailored marketing campaigns is crucial. Highlighting motorcycles' cost-effectiveness and convenience, especially in rural areas, could capture untapped markets.

Panelist 7: I'd also emphasize leveraging digital platforms for marketing. Social media campaigns and influencer partnerships could effectively reach younger demographics, who form a significant portion of potential buyers.

Panelist 2: To summarize, we identified key issues such as shifting preferences toward electric vehicles, economic constraints, and competition from public transport. Proposed solutions included developing electric motorcycles, offering financing options, launching exchange programs, and enhancing marketing efforts. Short-term actions like targeted campaigns and financing schemes can provide immediate relief, while long-term strategies like electric vehicle R&D will ensure sustained growth. Excellent contributions, everyone!

Ski Resort Staffing Issue

Panelist 1: Welcome, everyone. The topic for our discussion is "A ski resort is facing a declining footprint, and it is identified as a staff issue. Please propose solutions." Let's ensure our discussion is structured and focused. We'll start by identifying the root causes, propose potential solutions, and then evaluate their feasibility. Each of you will have a chance to contribute, so let's begin.

Panelist 2: Thank you. The declining footprint could stem from poor customer service, high staff turnover, or inadequate training. Customer dissatisfaction is likely a key issue if the staff lacks engagement or necessary skills.

Panelist 3: Adding to that, staff morale could be low due to poor working conditions or limited incentives. High absenteeism or a lack of motivation among employees can directly impact the customer experience.

Panelist 4: I agree with my colleague. Another potential root cause is ineffective leadership at the resort. If managers don't provide proper direction or feedback, staff performance will suffer, leading to a poor customer experience.

Panelist 5: Based on these issues, I propose a staff training program focused on customer service skills. Upskilling staff can boost their confidence and improve guest interactions.

Panelist 6: That's a great point. I'd also suggest introducing performance-based incentives, such as bonuses for positive guest reviews. This could motivate staff to perform better.

Panelist 7: I think we should address leadership issues as well. Implementing a feedback mechanism where staff can voice concerns and receive guidance from managers could foster a more supportive environment.

Panelist 8: Building on my colleague's point, I'd recommend setting up a staff engagement initiative, like team-building activities or recognition programs, to improve morale and reduce turnover.

Panelist 1: One of my colleague's training program ideas is feasible and can be rolled out in phases to manage costs. However, we must ensure that it's continuous and tailored to specific roles at the resort.

Panelist 2: I'd like to add that my colleague's incentive system could be linked to measurable metrics, like guest feedback scores or attendance. This makes it more transparent and impactful.

Panelist 3: Regarding leadership, we could conduct management workshops to train supervisors on effective team management. This aligns with some suggestions on fostering a positive work culture.

Panelist 4: Thank you for your inputs, everyone. To summarize, we identified poor customer service, low staff morale, and ineffective leadership as key issues. Proposed solutions include a comprehensive staff training program, performance-based incentives, and initiatives to improve leadership and staff engagement. All solutions seem feasible and align with the goal of addressing the root cause of the declining footprint. Excellent discussion!

Startup Technology Conflict

Panelist 1: Welcome, everyone. Today's topic is, "A startup is conflicted regarding using a new technology it developed versus giving it out to an expert car company to use. Please propose solutions." Let's structure our discussion by exploring the pros and cons of both approaches, then suggesting actionable steps. Each of us will have the opportunity to contribute. Let's begin.

Panelist 2: One key advantage of using the technology in-house is retaining full control over its application and intellectual property. This could allow the startup to establish itself as a leader in innovation and capture significant market share.

Panelist 3: Building on that, focusing on in-house application could also enable the startup to differentiate itself from competitors. However, this would require substantial investment in production, marketing, and distribution, which may stretch resources.

Panelist 4: On the other hand, licensing the technology to an established car company could provide immediate revenue and reduce financial risk. Partnering with an expert in the field would also ensure the technology is utilized at scale and with high efficiency.

Panelist 5: I'd like to point out that giving the technology to a car company might limit the startup's ability to establish its own brand identity. While it's a safer approach, the startup could lose out on long-term benefits.

Panelist 2: Considering the financial constraints most startups face, licensing might be the more feasible option in the short term. The revenue generated could be reinvested into R&D or future projects.

Panelist 1: My colleague's point is valid, but I'd argue that if the startup can secure funding or a strategic partner, they could explore a hybrid approach. For instance, applying the technology in-house for niche markets while licensing it for mass production.

Panelist 3: Another perspective to consider is the startup's expertise. If the company lacks experience in large-scale manufacturing or distribution, it would be more prudent to collaborate with a car company that excels in these areas.

Panelist 5: However, my colleague's earlier mention of brand identity cannot be ignored. By outsourcing entirely, the startup risks being overshadowed by the car company's branding, which may diminish the technology's association with its true innovator.

Panelist 4: One potential solution is negotiating a co-branding agreement with the car company. This way, the startup's contribution is prominently acknowledged, ensuring visibility while benefiting from the partner's expertise.

Panelist 2: Additionally, the startup could retain certain exclusive rights, such as developing applications for specific industries or regions. This would allow them to maintain some control and revenue streams.

Panelist 3: Their colleague's suggestion of a hybrid approach resonates strongly with me. Starting with licensing for quick revenue while building capabilities for in-house applications could provide a balanced path forward.

Panelist 4: To summarize, we discussed the advantages of both in-house application and licensing. In-house use ensures control and brand identity but requires significant investment, while licensing offers immediate revenue and scalability but risks brand overshadowing. A hybrid approach, combining selective in-house application with strategic licensing, appears to balance short-term feasibility with long-term goals. Additionally, co-branding agreements and retaining exclusive rights were highlighted as actionable strategies to address the dilemma effectively. Excellent discussion, everyone!

Mergers & Acquisitions — Pre & Post-Merger Considerations

Panelist 1: Welcome, everyone. The topic for today's discussion is, "What should be considered pre- and post-merger in a mergers and acquisitions scenario?" Let's structure this by discussing pre-merger considerations first, followed by post-merger strategies. Each of us will contribute to both aspects. Let's begin.

Panelist 2: One critical aspect pre-merger is conducting thorough due diligence. This includes analyzing financial statements, legal liabilities, and operational metrics to ensure there are no hidden risks.

Panelist 3: Adding to that, assessing cultural compatibility is equally important. Even if the financial metrics align, cultural mismatches between companies can create significant integration challenges.

Panelist 1: Building on my colleague's points, evaluating synergies is essential. This includes understanding cost-saving opportunities, revenue growth potential, and any operational redundancies that can be optimized post-merger.

Panelist 3: Post-merger, the immediate priority is integration planning. This involves aligning organizational structures, streamlining operations, and ensuring clear communication across all levels.

Panelist 2: I agree with my colleague. Additionally, retaining key talent is critical. Offering incentives and addressing concerns proactively can help minimize attrition and ensure smooth operations.

Panelist 1: Another post-merger consideration is monitoring performance through key performance indicators (KPIs). This ensures that the projected synergies and financial benefits are being realized effectively.

Panelist 2: Evaluating the success of the merger requires regular reviews against initial objectives. If the merger aimed to expand market share, then tracking sales and market penetration metrics is vital.

Panelist 3: Their colleague's point is valid. Moreover, focusing on long-term strategy, such as investing in joint R&D or exploring new markets, can maximize the benefits of the merger.

Panelist 1: Lastly, maintaining stakeholder confidence is crucial. Transparent reporting and regular updates to investors, employees, and customers can strengthen trust and ensure long-term success.

Panelist 2: To summarize, pre-merger considerations should include due diligence, cultural compatibility, and synergy evaluation. Post-merger priorities involve integration planning, talent retention, and performance monitoring. Long-term strategies like joint R&D and stakeholder engagement are also vital for sustained success. Excellent discussion, everyone!

Transitioning to Green Energy — Wind vs. Solar Investment Decision

Panelist 1: Welcome, everyone. The topic for today's discussion is, "A company transitioning to green energy must choose between cost-effective wind energy and solar energy, which is more expensive but has a higher lifespan. What factors should be considered while making this investment decision?" Let's divide our discussion into evaluating cost, performance, and long-term sustainability. Let's begin.

Panelist 2: When considering costs, upfront investment is a key factor. Wind energy has lower initial costs compared to solar energy, which might make it more appealing for companies with limited budgets.

Panelist 3: While that is true, solar energy's longer lifespan reduces replacement costs over time. Factoring in the levelized cost of energy (LCOE) might provide a clearer picture of overall affordability.

Panelist 1: My colleague's point about LCOE is crucial. Additionally, government incentives or subsidies for either option should also be considered, as they can significantly offset initial investments.

Panelist 3: Wind energy's performance depends heavily on location, requiring consistent wind speeds to remain viable. This can be a limitation in areas with variable wind patterns.

Panelist 2: Solar energy, on the other hand, offers more reliability as sunlight is generally predictable. Advances in battery storage technology further enhance its viability by addressing intermittency issues.

Panelist 1: Another point to consider is maintenance. Wind turbines often require more frequent maintenance due to moving parts, whereas solar panels are relatively low-maintenance.

Panelist 2: From a sustainability perspective, solar energy's longer lifespan means fewer replacements and reduced environmental impact over time, aligning with the company's green energy goals.

Panelist 3: However, wind energy's shorter payback period can free up capital for other sustainable initiatives sooner. The choice depends on whether the company prioritizes immediate returns or long-term benefits.

Panelist 1: It's also important to consider the scalability of each option. Solar farms can be expanded incrementally, offering flexibility, while wind energy installations may require significant upfront planning.

Panelist 3: To summarize, factors like upfront costs, performance reliability, maintenance, long-term sustainability, and scalability must all be considered. Wind energy offers cost-effectiveness and quicker returns, while solar energy provides greater longevity and environmental benefits. The final decision should align with the company's financial capacity, location-specific factors, and long-term sustainability goals. Excellent discussion, everyone!

FORMAT FOR TAS GROUP DISCUSSION

Introduction (1 Minute)

Role of the Chairman:

One participant is assigned the role of the Chairman at the start of the GD.

The Chairman's responsibilities include:

- Explaining the Case/Topic:** Read or summarize the case provided by the panel. Ensure everyone understands the topic, context, and key elements of the problem.
- Providing Context:** Highlight the background, objectives, and scope of the discussion. This sets a clear direction for the participants.

Key Objective:

The Chairman's role is not to dominate the GD but to ensure that all participants start on the same page with a clear understanding of the topic.

Discussion (6 Minutes)

Open Discussion:

- All participants (except the Chairman) engage in discussing the topic.
- The focus should be on **analyzing the problem, exploring various perspectives, and identifying solutions.**

Role of the Participants:

- Contribute meaningfully to the discussion by presenting relevant points, insights & solutions.
- Respect others' viewpoints and avoid interruptions.
- Back your arguments with facts, logic, and structured reasoning.

Role of the Chairman During Discussion:

- Observe the discussion and take notes on the key points raised by participants.
- Intervene only if:
 - The discussion goes off-track.
 - Important aspects of the case are being overlooked.

Key Objective:

This phase focuses on collaborative problem-solving, with participants working towards a consensus or exploring diverse perspectives.

Conclusion (1 Minute)

Role of the Chairman:

- Summarize the discussion in a structured manner by:
 - Highlighting key points raised by the participants.
 - Identifying areas of agreement or disagreement.
 - Summing up any consensus reached or diverse perspectives shared.
- Conclude by thanking the panelists for their contributions.

Key Objective:

The Chairman's summary should encapsulate the discussion clearly and concisely, showcasing the group's ability to work towards a solution-oriented approach.

Important Points to Note

The **Chairman's Role** is critical for maintaining structure and focus during the GD.

Participants are evaluated on their **ability to contribute effectively, teamwork, and problem-solving skills.**

The GD should not only highlight individual performance but also demonstrate the group's capability to work collaboratively.

Do's : What should you do during a TAS GD

Be Cordial and Professional

Why: The GD is a professional environment where respectful behavior is crucial. Aggressive or dismissive attitudes can hurt your impression.

How: Use polite language, acknowledge others' contributions, and avoid interrupting. For example, start with phrases like *"Building on your point..."* or *"I agree with your perspective and would like to add..."*.

Listen Active

Why: Listening shows respect and helps you understand different viewpoints, which is essential for consensus-building.

How: Maintain eye contact with the speaker, nod occasionally to show understanding, and avoid multitasking or appearing distracted.

Maintain Proper Body Language

Why: Non-verbal cues like posture and eye contact influence how others perceive your confidence and engagement.

How: Sit straight, avoid slouching, and keep your hands on the table or your lap. Avoid excessive hand gestures or leaning back.

Take Notes

Why: Jotting down key points helps you structure your thoughts and recall important arguments during the discussion.

How: Use a notebook to note down relevant facts, strong arguments, or points to counter respectfully.

Back Arguments with Facts and Logic

Why: TAS values analytical and structured thinking. Unsupported opinions appear weak and unprofessional.

How: Use data, examples, or frameworks to support your points. For instance, say *"Based on industry trends, companies in this sector have seen..."*.

Present Alternative Viewpoints

Why: Presenting diverse ideas while respecting others' opinions demonstrates open-mindedness and problem-solving skills.

How: Use phrases like *"Another way to approach this could be..."* or *"Considering a different perspective..."*.

Focus on Consensus

Why: TAS evaluates teamwork and the ability to drive solutions collaboratively.

How: Encourage group alignment by summarizing key agreements and proposing actionable steps.

Uphold Integrity and Ethics

Why: The TATA Group prioritizes ethical decision-making. A lack of integrity can be a disqualifier.

How: Address ethical dilemmas by emphasizing transparency, fairness, and professionalism. For instance, if bribery is part of a case, propose alternative, ethical solutions.

Don'ts: What should you avoid during a TAS GD

Don't Be Disruptive

Why: A chaotic or argumentative approach disrupts the discussion and reflects poorly on your ability to collaborate.

How to Avoid: Keep the tone calm and focus on solutions rather than arguments. Avoid raising your voice or dominating the conversation.

Don't Interrupt Others

Why: Interrupting is disrespectful and shows poor listening skills. It can also lead to missing valuable points.

How to Avoid: Wait for the speaker to finish before presenting your point. If you must interject, do so politely with phrases like *"May I add something here?"*.

Avoid Extreme or Judgmental Views

Why: Extreme opinions can alienate others and make you appear inflexible. TAS values balanced and reasonable arguments.

How to Avoid: Phrase your points diplomatically, e.g., *"While this approach has its merits, we should also consider..."*.

Don't Defend Unreasonably

Why: Stubbornly defending your point may make you appear rigid and unable to collaborate.

How to Avoid: Be open to revising your stance if new, valid points are presented.

Don't Show Fatigue

Why: Non-verbal cues like slouching or zoning out can give the impression that you're disengaged.

How to Avoid: Stay alert by actively listening, maintaining good posture, and staying mentally present even during longer discussions.

Avoid Dismissiveness

Why: TAS expects candidates to consider managerial implications rather than dismissing problems outright.

How to Avoid: Address challenges with constructive solutions. For example, instead of blaming ineffective employees, propose solutions like training, reassessment, or role realignment.

Don't Ignore Time Management

Why: Poor time management can derail the discussion and leave critical points unexplored.

How to Avoid: Allocate time wisely for exploring facets of the case, brainstorming solutions, and reaching a conclusion.

Don't Lose Professionalism

Why: TAS values professionalism throughout the process. A lapse in behavior can disqualify the entire group.

How to Avoid: Stay calm, polite, and respectful, even when disagreements arise.

How to prepare

Develop Business Acumen

- Stay updated with current affairs, business news, and economic trends, particularly focusing on **Tata Group developments** and industry shifts.
- Read business newspapers like *Economic Times*, *Mint*, *Business Standard*, and follow credible online sources such as *Harvard Business Review* or *McKinsey Insights*.
- Study **company annual reports** and **financial statements** to understand key business strategies and performance metrics.
- Practice **case studies** to develop structured thinking, decision-making, & problem-solving skills.
- Keep track of **government policies**, **corporate governance trends**, and **ethical business practices** relevant to the Tata Group.

Enhance Communication Skills

- Engage in **mock GDs and case discussions** to practice articulation, clarity, and logical structuring of thoughts.
- Work on **active listening** to acknowledge different perspectives and build on others' points.
- Structure responses using frameworks like **PREP (Point, Reason, Example, Point)** or **MECE (Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive)** for clear communication.
- Focus on maintaining a professional and confident **body language, tone, and eye contact** during discussions.
- Learn to **handle counterarguments** diplomatically and support viewpoints with **facts and logical reasoning**.

Build Analytical and Solution-Oriented Thinking:

- **Analyze problems deeply** before jumping to conclusions. Understand the root cause rather than just addressing symptoms.
- Use structured frameworks like:
- **5 Whys Analysis** – Identify the core reason behind an issue.
- **SWOT Analysis** – Understand Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats.
- **Cost-Benefit Analysis** – Assess financial and operational feasibility.
- **Decision Matrix** – Compare multiple solutions based on key parameters.

Demonstrate Real-Life Examples of Integrity

- Ethical decision-making is crucial in Tata Group companies, given their strong legacy of **values and corporate governance**.
- Refer to **real-life Tata Group case studies** where ethical dilemmas were handled professionally:
- **Tata Motors' stance on bribery** – The company refused to engage in unethical practices and maintained its integrity.
- **Tata Steel's approach to sustainability** – Ethical sourcing, employee welfare, and environmental responsibility.
- Develop a strong **ethical framework** to tackle workplace dilemmas, ensuring **transparency, fairness, and long-term sustainability**.
- When discussing case studies or GD topics, align responses with Tata's **founding principles of trust, leadership, and ethical business conduct**.

PREVIOUS GD TOPICS

1. You're a regional sales manager who has significantly fallen short of this month's target. You can either report the shortfall or advance next month's promotions to this month and report the data. How will you proceed?

2. Your organization regularly holds general assemblies. Ten employees have approached you to have a religious prayer at the end of the assembly. How will you proceed?

3. Journalists uncover and expose that one of your employees has received kickbacks from one of your vendors and favors them over others. How will you proceed?

4. One of your employees regularly shows up late to work and does not meet targets. You have also found out recently that they are working for another organization simultaneously. How will you proceed?

5. Your organization has a procurement manager who has been working in the company for 20 years and is well-liked and respected. A junior manager under him, working for 3 years, has helped improve company profits. However, the procurement manager thinks the junior manager favors some suppliers over others, which is not in the company's best interest, and has approached you with this concern. How will you proceed?

6. During a major event organized by your company, where the Chief Minister is attending as a guest, a female employee reports being molested by a male colleague just before the event starts. How should you respond?

7. Your airline company has been bearing losses for months. Issues like the absence of dynamic pricing or ill-trained staff have been highlighted. Additionally, flooding in the northeast regions of India has left four flights scheduled on that route next week nearly vacant. What steps will you take?

8. Your gram panchayat has been allocated a budget. You must decide whether to build a school, women's toilets, or a community hall. What will you prioritize?

9. A trustee asks you for a favor to employ his nephew in the company via backdoor recruitment. How will you handle this?

10. Your leading skincare company recently launched a sunscreen that has been majorly successful. However, seven complaints of skin issues have been reported. How will you proceed?

11. As the CEO of a globally recognized FMCG company, you face a major crisis. A reputable environmental NGO has accused your company of greenwashing, claiming your "100% biodegradable" packaging contains non-biodegradable elements. Independent tests confirm that the accusations are partially true. Pulling the product could lead to severe financial losses and disrupt supply chains, while continuing its sale might provoke public outrage and long-term reputational damage.

12. As the CEO of a fast-growing textile company, you have an opportunity to expand into a Southeast Asian market with high demand for affordable clothing. However, meeting local pricing demands would require sourcing from suppliers with questionable labor practices, compromising the company's sustainability goals. How should you balance the pressure for growth with your core values of sustainability?

13. You are the HR head of a leading logistics firm that has developed AI tools to automate warehouse operations, improving efficiency by 40% and saving millions annually. However, this would displace over 30% of your workforce, many of whom are located in regions with scarce alternative employment opportunities. The company prides itself on being an "employee-first organization." How will you implement automation while ensuring employee trust and protecting your brand's reputation?

14. You're the National Manager at a retail company, where you discover that a high-performing regional sales manager has been offering unethical incentives to retailers, significantly boosting sales. Firing them aligns with company values but risks disrupting key retail relationships and market share. Retaining them could encourage unethical behavior across the organization.

15. As the CEO of a global IT giant headquartered in the U.S., your company recently acquired a Japanese firm specializing in cutting-edge AI technologies. However, cultural clashes are hampering integration efforts. Japanese employees perceive American management practices as overly aggressive, while the American team sees the Japanese work culture as slow and hierarchical. What strategy should you adopt as the CEO to ensure successful cultural integration and improved productivity?

PREVIOUS GD TOPICS

16. As the head of the Quality Assurance department of a leading pharmaceutical company, you discover a minor flaw in the packaging of one of your best-selling diabetes medications. While there's no evidence of harm to patients, regulatory authorities have issued an advisory, and media outlets are reporting the issue. A product recall could harm investor confidence, but ignoring the problem may lead to larger reputational and regulatory consequences.

17. As the CEO of a consumer goods company, you're considering expansion into a Middle Eastern country with immense growth potential. However, the region is politically unstable, and several global brands have faced backlash due to local conflicts. Expanding could boost revenues and shareholder confidence but also risks reputational damage. What strategy will you, as the CEO, adopt to navigate this situation?

18. As the CEO of a leading apparel brand, investigative journalists reveal that one of your key suppliers uses exploitative child labor practices, sparking a public boycott of your products. Shifting to a new supplier is possible but would increase costs by 20%, impacting product pricing and margins. What immediate actions will you, as the CEO, take to address the issue and mitigate reputational and financial risks?

19. As the Sarpanch of a village, you are approached by a large chemical company that wants to set up a plant on the outskirts of your village. The company promises significant economic benefits, including employment for hundreds of villagers and investments in local infrastructure such as schools and healthcare facilities. However, experts warn that the plant will likely pollute the nearby river, which is the primary source of water for farming, drinking, and daily activities. The villagers are divided: some see the project as a solution to unemployment, while others fear it will harm their health and agricultural livelihoods in the long run. How will you navigate this situation to balance the economic opportunities with the environmental and social concerns of your village?

20. As the CEO of a leading multi-specialty hospital, a senior surgeon has been accused of negligence leading to a patient's death during surgery. The family is threatening legal action, and the incident is being widely reported in the media. The surgeon has an excellent track record and denies the allegations. While conducting an internal investigation, you face pressure to publicly defend the hospital's reputation without compromising patient trust. What should your strategy be to address this crisis and prevent future incidents?

21. As the Principal of a reputed private school, a senior teacher has been accused of sexual misconduct by a student. The teacher has denied the allegations, but the parents of the student have lodged an official complaint, and the media is starting to take notice. Other students and staff members are divided on whether the allegations are true. You need to ensure a fair investigation without damaging the school's reputation or neglecting the well-being of the student.

22. As the Principal of an elite high school, parents are pressuring you to introduce a more career-oriented curriculum focused on STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, Mathematics). However, many teachers argue that a broader curriculum, including arts and humanities, fosters better holistic development. Implementing the new curriculum may require laying off non-STEM teachers and increasing tuition fees. What strategy should you adopt to address these competing demands while ensuring quality education?

23. As the CEO of a chain of private schools, you've announced a fee hike to fund new infrastructure and technology upgrades. Parents have started protesting, arguing that the fee increase is unaffordable, especially for middle-income families. Some have threatened to withdraw their children, which could affect the school's enrollment numbers. How will you manage this situation while balancing financial requirements and parents' concerns?

Part E – HR Answers

[Main Index](#)

Tips for Preparing Your Answers

General tips and tricks to write your HR answers

Understand the Question Thoroughly

Take time to grasp what the question is truly asking. Break it into components if needed. This ensures your response addresses all aspects.

Use Structured Frameworks

Organize your answers using frameworks like STAR or COIN. These frameworks help in delivering concise and impactful answers.

Tailor Your Answers

Customize your response to reflect the values and requirements of the company and role. Show alignment with their culture and goals.

Example:

If the company values innovation, mention situations where you introduced new ideas or processes.

Be Authentic and Genuine

Share real experiences. Authenticity builds trust and ensures consistency during follow-up questions in interviews.

Avoid exaggerating achievements. Stick to facts that you can defend.

Highlight Relevant Skills and Experiences

Ensure your answers demonstrate skills relevant to the role, such as leadership, teamwork, or problem-solving.

Focus on Positivity

Even when discussing challenges, focus on how you overcame them or what you learned. Avoid blaming others or appearing overly negative.

Example:

“Describe a time you failed.”

- “In my first internship, I underestimated the timeline for a project, causing a delay. I quickly learned the importance of setting realistic expectations and have since consistently delivered projects on time.”

Be Concise but Comprehensive

Avoid rambling. Stick to the key points while ensuring your response is well-rounded and informative.

Practice delivering answers within 1-1.5 minutes, hitting all critical elements without unnecessary details.

General tips and tricks to write your HR answers

Showcase a Range of Experiences

Use varied examples from academics, work experience, internships, or extracurriculars to avoid repetition and highlight your diverse skillset.

Demonstrate Self-Awareness

When discussing weaknesses or feedback, show how you've worked to improve. This indicates maturity and a growth mindset.

Quantify Your Achievements

Where possible, back your answers with numbers or tangible outcomes to add credibility.

Research the Company Thoroughly

Incorporate company-specific details to make your answers more relatable and relevant.

Maintain a Professional and Positive Tone

Avoid casual language or humor that could be misinterpreted. Stick to a confident and professional tone.

Seek Feedback on Your Answers

Practice with peers, mentors, or tools like mock interviews. Constructive feedback can help refine your responses.

Keep Grammar and Language Polished

Ensure clarity and correctness in written HR answers. Use tools like Grammarly for error-free writing.

End on a Strong Note

Conclude your answers with a result, lesson learned, or value added to leave a lasting impression.

Commonly asked HR questions and how to prepare for them

Behavioral Questions

Sample Behavioral Questions

1. Tell me about a time when you had to overcome a significant challenge at work.
2. Describe a situation where you worked under pressure to meet a deadline.
3. Give an example of a time you had to handle multiple competing priorities.
4. Tell me about a time when you made a mistake at work. How did you handle it?
5. Describe a situation where you had to influence others to achieve a goal.
6. Can you share an example of when you had to resolve a conflict within a team?
7. Tell me about a time when you demonstrated leadership in a project or task.
8. Share an example of a time when you received critical feedback. How did you respond?
9. Describe a time when you went above and beyond what was expected of you at work.
10. Can you give an example of when you worked with a difficult colleague and how you handled the situation?

Tips for Tackling Behavioral Questions

1. **Use the STAR or COIN Framework:**
 - Structure your response by outlining the frameworks. This helps provide a clear, concise, and complete answer.
2. **Focus on Results:**
 - Emphasize the positive outcome of the situation, especially how your actions led to a successful resolution or improvement. This demonstrates your impact in a real-world scenario.
3. **Be Honest but Positive:**
 - Don't shy away from mentioning challenges or mistakes but always highlight how you learned from the experience and how you would approach it differently now.

Motivational Questions

Sample Motivational Questions

1. Why did you choose to pursue an MBA?
2. What motivates you to work in this industry?
3. Why do you want to work for our company specifically?
4. What are your short-term and long-term career goals?
5. Why do you think this role is the right fit for you?
6. Can you tell me about a time when you felt most passionate about your work?
7. What made you choose this particular career path?
8. Why did you decide to leave your previous job?
9. What is the most rewarding part of your job?
10. What is your driving force when facing tough situations at work?

Tips for Tackling Motivational Questions

1. **Be Authentic and Reflective:**
 - Be honest about your reasons for pursuing certain career moves or decisions. Reflect on your personal values, aspirations, and what truly drives you.
2. **Align with Company Values:**
 - Research the company's culture, mission, and values beforehand. Tailor your answers to demonstrate how your motivations align with the company's goals and culture.
3. **Show Long-Term Vision:**
 - Make sure to emphasize how your motivations and goals evolve over time. Companies appreciate candidates who are not only passionate but also forward-thinking in their career aspirations.

Commonly asked HR questions and how to prepare for them

Strengths and Weaknesses Questions

Sample Strengths and Weaknesses Questions

1. What do you consider your greatest strength?
2. What is one strength you have that you feel sets you apart from other candidates?
3. How do you leverage your strengths in your current role?
4. What is your biggest weakness, and how are you working to improve it?
5. Can you tell me about a time when you used your strengths to overcome a challenge?
6. What skill do you think you could improve on, and what steps are you taking to develop it?
7. How do you ensure your weaknesses don't impact your work performance?
8. What feedback have you received about your strengths and weaknesses from colleagues or supervisors?
9. Can you share an instance when you turned a weakness into a strength?
10. How do you handle situations where your strengths may not be enough to meet a challenge?

Tips for Tackling Strengths and Weaknesses Questions

1. **Be Self-Aware and Balanced:**
 - Acknowledge your strengths confidently but also be open and honest about your weaknesses. Avoid focusing only on one or the other—provide a balanced view of both.
2. **Focus on Improvement for Weaknesses:**
 - When discussing a weakness, show that you're proactive about addressing it. Mention steps you're actively taking to overcome or manage it.
3. **Tailor Strengths to the Role:**
 - Choose strengths that align with the requirements of the position you're applying for.

Situational Questions

Sample Situational Questions

1. How would you handle a situation where your team is not meeting deadlines?
2. If you were given a project with tight deadlines and limited resources, how would you prioritize tasks?
3. How would you handle a conflict between two team members who are not getting along?
4. If you had to implement a major change in your team, how would you ensure it's accepted?
5. How would you manage a situation where you disagree with your manager on a strategy?
6. If you had to work with a colleague who is consistently underperforming, how would you address it?
7. What would you do if you had to lead a team of people from diverse backgrounds with differing opinions?
8. How would you manage a high-pressure situation where a client is dissatisfied with your team's work?
9. If you were faced with a difficult decision that could affect the company's reputation, how would you proceed?
10. If you were leading a project and a team member was not contributing, how would you handle it?

Tips for Tackling Situational Questions

1. **Show Decision-Making and Problem-Solving:**
 - Demonstrate your ability to think critically, make well-informed decisions, and take practical steps to resolve challenges effectively. Employers want to see your process for navigating complex scenarios.
2. **Emphasize Collaboration and Adaptability:**
 - Highlight your teamwork and adaptability. Situational questions often test how well you collaborate with others in uncertain circumstances.

Commonly asked HR questions and how to prepare for them

Leadership Questions

Sample Leadership Questions

1. Can you describe a time when you led a team through a challenging situation?
2. How do you motivate your team during difficult times?
3. Tell me about a time when you had to take charge of a project with minimal guidance.
4. How do you ensure all team members feel valued and included?
5. Describe a situation where you had to influence others to accept your viewpoint.
6. How do you delegate tasks and responsibilities to your team?
7. Tell me about a time when you had to make a tough decision as a leader.
8. How do you handle team members who are not contributing to the group's success?
9. What is your leadership style, and how has it evolved over time?
10. Can you provide an example of how you've developed others in your team?

Tips for Tackling Leadership Questions

1. **Highlight Your Leadership Style:**
 - Clearly communicate your leadership approach (e.g., coaching, transformational, collaborative) and provide examples of how you've applied this style to manage or motivate teams effectively.
2. **Focus on Results and Impact:**
 - Emphasize the outcomes of your leadership decisions. Explain not only the challenges but also how your leadership led to positive results, whether it's improved team performance, successful project completion, or enhanced morale.
3. **Demonstrate Emotional Intelligence:**
 - Showcase your ability to understand and manage emotions in yourself and others. Good leaders are empathetic and able to navigate interpersonal dynamics, so mention instances where you effectively managed conflict or motivated others.

Teamwork Questions

Sample Teamwork Questions

1. Can you describe a time when you worked with a team to accomplish a challenging goal?
2. How do you ensure effective communication within a team?
3. Tell me about a time when you had a disagreement with a team member. How did you resolve it?
4. What role do you usually take in a team setting?
5. How do you handle situations where team members are not pulling their weight?
6. How do you contribute to fostering a positive and collaborative team environment?
7. Can you give an example of a project where you worked closely with others and achieved a great result?
8. How do you deal with differences in opinion or work styles within a team?
9. Tell me about a time when you had to take the lead in a team, even though you were not the official leader.
10. How do you ensure that all voices are heard in a team discussion or meeting?

Tips for Tackling Teamwork Questions

1. **Emphasize Collaboration and Adaptability:**
 - Focus on your ability to work well with diverse team members, adapt to different working styles, and collaborate towards shared goals.
2. **Demonstrate Conflict Resolution Skills:**
 - Teamwork isn't always smooth sailing, so provide examples where you successfully managed conflict or disagreements.
3. **Highlight Team Achievements and Personal Contribution:**
 - While teamwork is about collective effort, make sure to showcase your individual contributions within the team setting.

Commonly asked HR questions and how to prepare for them

Conflict Questions

Sample Conflict Questions

1. Tell me about a time when you had a disagreement with a colleague. How did you resolve it?
2. Can you describe a situation where you disagreed with your manager's approach? How did you handle it?
3. How do you handle conflicts within a team?
4. What would you do if a team member was consistently undermining your ideas in meetings?
5. Tell me about a time when you had to address a difficult situation with a client.
6. Have you ever faced a situation where your personal values conflicted with the company's objectives? How did you navigate it?
7. How would you handle a scenario where two of your team members were having an ongoing conflict?
8. Describe a time when you had to work with someone you didn't get along with. How did you manage the relationship?
9. How do you handle negative feedback or criticism from peers or supervisors?
10. If you had a conflict with a senior colleague, how would you go about resolving it without escalating the issue?

Tips for Tackling Conflict Questions

1. **Focus on Resolution and Collaboration:**
 - Show that you prioritize finding mutually beneficial solutions and maintaining positive relationships, rather than letting conflict escalate.
2. **Use Specific Examples:**
 - Provide clear, real-life examples of conflicts you've experienced, explaining the context, your actions, and the outcome.

Abstract Questions

Sample Abstract/Philosophical Questions

1. If you could change one thing about the world, what would it be and why?
2. How do you define leadership?
3. If you had to make a difficult decision that was morally right but professionally risky, what would you do?
4. If you had unlimited resources, what project or cause would you pursue?
5. How do you balance personal ambition with the greater good?
6. What role do ethics play in decision-making, and how do you apply them in your career?
7. Do you believe that people can truly change, or do they remain the same?

Tips for Tackling Abstract/Philosophical Questions

1. **Reflect on Personal Values:**
 - These questions are designed to assess your values and thought processes. Reflect on your personal beliefs and experiences, and ensure your response aligns with your core values.
2. **Be Honest and Thoughtful:**
 - Avoid overthinking or trying to guess what the interviewer wants to hear. Be genuine in your response. A thoughtful, introspective answer that shows self-awareness will stand out.
3. **Connect Philosophy to Practicality:**
 - While these questions may seem abstract, tie them back to your real-world experiences and the professional environment. Showing how your personal philosophy influences your work and decision-making can add depth to your answer.

General tips and tricks to prepare questions to ask at the end of the interview

Analyze Job Descriptions (JDs): Understand the role's expectations thoroughly. Align your questions to explore job-specific nuances, challenges, and opportunities.

Focus on Current Trends: Prepare questions reflecting your awareness of industry trends or company-specific developments, showing you're up-to-date and proactive.

Open-Ended and Thought-Provoking: Frame questions that encourage the interviewer to share detailed insights rather than simple "yes" or "no" answers.

Highlight Alignment: Use questions to subtly show how your skills and aspirations align with the company's mission and values.

Highlight Relevant Skills and Experiences: Ensure your answers demonstrate skills relevant to the role, such as leadership, teamwork, or problem-solving.

Explore Growth and Development Opportunities: This indicates a long-term commitment and shows you are proactive about your career development.

Understand Company Culture and Values Questions about culture reveal your desire to fit into the organization's ethos and work environment.

Gauge Expectations for Success This helps you understand the key performance indicators (KPIs) and what success looks like in the role.

Inquire About Team Dynamics Show your interest in collaborative work and understanding the team environment.

Learn About Cross-Functional Opportunities These questions reveal your interest in the company's holistic operations and your desire to grow beyond your immediate role.

Understand Career Trajectories Reflects your desire for career growth and clarity about potential paths within the organization.

Part F – Interview Experiences

[Main Index](#)

B.E (Computer Science) | Workex – 33 months as a Developer in TCS

Why did you choose FMS over other B schools ?

I chose FMS because it is a Tier 1 B-school located in the heart of Delhi, a city I have always loved due to its rich cultural roots. The student-driven culture at FMS greatly appealed to me, as it fosters a collaborative and dynamic learning environment. Additionally, having previously experienced a traditional campus life, I was intrigued by the distinct setup of FMS.

Which book has had the greatest impact on you, and why? (Question on mentioned interest)

I read a book named To Kill a Mockingbird that profoundly impacted me. It explores complex themes like racism and classism through a child's eyes and teaches a powerful lesson in integrity, shown by the protagonist's father standing firm despite opposition.

What were two challenges you faced during your work experience at TCS?

During my time at TCS, I faced two main challenges. First, typecasting limited my ability to explore new domains as roles were assigned based on previous technology experience. Second, learning saturation occurred due to infrequent project rotations, causing the learning curve to plateau and hindering skill development.

Having worked at TCS, a service-based company, and interned at Microsoft, a product-based company, what differences did you notice between the two work environments?

At Microsoft, the exchange of ideas across teams happened at a much faster pace, often through informal conversations like coffee or dinner chats, even with people from completely unrelated teams. This is something I personally experienced. In TCS, the development process tends to follow a similar structure across various teams, maintaining a consistent framework. In contrast, at Microsoft, the development process varies significantly from product to product, tailored to the scale and nature of each specific project.

If you were to receive an offer from us and then get an offer from Microsoft shortly after, would you choose to leave us for them?

At this early stage of my career, I aim to explore various roles and domains to discover my true calling. Even if Microsoft were to offer me a product manager role, I would prefer not to take it right now, as it could limit my opportunities by confining me to a single role.

But they'll offer you a higher salary, and we won't be able to match that. Do you believe that salary isn't important to you?

While I acknowledge that money is essential for sustenance, an MBA from FMS, in particular, enables one to look beyond financial considerations and focus on the bigger picture and personal growth. Since I won't have immediate financial liabilities after graduation, money will not be my top priority.

How would you go about digitizing the public land record system? (CV Related)

Digitizing every aspect of the value chain end-to-end, incorporating use cases like GIS for mapping, RPA for data entry automation, developing a platform similar to India Stack for seamless digital infrastructure and accessibility, and utilizing NFTs for ownership verification.

What is DevOps? (CV Related)

DevOps is a set of practices that combines software development and IT operations to automate and improve the processes of software delivery and infrastructure management.

Can you describe a use case where DevOps practices are applied to automate the entire software delivery lifecycle?

By implementing continuous integration and continuous deployment (CI/CD) pipelines, a company can automate code integration, testing, and deployment, allowing for faster delivery of new features and more reliable updates to production environments.

Ok , so let's suppose the revenue of a college is decreasing , what could be the possible reasons ?

Reiterating the problem statement, the client is a college and they have been experiencing a decline in revenue. I would also want to know the location where they are situated , revenue model of the college?

Yes , the institute is in Delhi and the revenue streams you can consider are tuition fees, government grants, donations, or auxiliary services like cafeteria and events . There is no hostel in the institute

Ok , Do you have any information on the magnitude and timeline of decline . What are courses offered and is there a particular revenue stream that is affecting the revenue? Is it a private or a public college

B.E (Computer Science) | Workex – 33 months as a Developer in TCS

Magnitude of decline is 10-15% and they have been seeing this decline from the past 2 years. They have both Undergraduate and postgraduate programs in engineering .The Private institute have been seeing a decline in the admissions for both the programs

Okay. Got it . Is it something that only they have facing or other colleges as well nearby.

Yes , others are also seeing a decline .lets focus on only the private institutes like us .

Ok could be an external issue . admissions, revenue coming from basically enrollments have declined . It could be that the no of students coming to the college have declined or the fee that we charge has declined . Since decline is due to admissions, I believe it is something related to possible new students .

Great , so actually the number of new students taking admissions have declined .

Ok , It could be an internal issue maybe the no of seats we offer have declined , or some course is no longer provided or something related to the faculty as well. But since competitors have also seen a decline, it could be an external issue as well . Do you want to focus on any one of them or should I explore both .

It is not something related to the institute so we can focus on the external issues.

For external issues I want to focus on Competition , Market demand , Regulatory changes or something like the pandemic . Do you think this is comprehensive enough ?

It is an issue related to the competition ;what do you think it could be ?

We can focus on 2 things , New competition and Old competition . When you say competitors also face a decline is it that all competitors face it or only a few .Because if not all it can be that some of the existing institutes have 1. made changes to course attracting more admissions or 2. decreased fee . 3. some other change curriculum . Incase all face an issue a new competitor could have come in the market .

Exactly , a new college has cropped up in the vicinity and they have done very heavy targeted marketing which is why they are eating up our new enrollments and hence the revenue.

B.Tech (Computer Science) | Workex – 15 months

The District Magistrate is planning to sell one of the colleges. Analyze three major cost drivers

1. Administrative Costs

Cost Drivers: Administrative tasks such as admissions, student registration, scheduling, and record-keeping can be labor-intensive and time-consuming.

2. Energy and Facility Management Costs

Cost Drivers: Utilities and maintenance of campus facilities can be significant expenses, especially with large infrastructure like classrooms, dormitories, and recreational areas.

3. Teaching and Learning Costs

Cost Drivers: Traditional classroom teaching involves significant overheads in terms of faculty salaries, classroom space, and materials.

How do you think we can reduce them using some technology ?

1 . Administrative Costs : Implementing a comprehensive Student Information System (SIS) or Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) system can automate administrative tasks. This reduces manual labor, streamlines processes, and ensures efficient handling of student data, thus cutting down on administrative costs.

2. Energy and Facility Management Costs : Smart building technologies (e.g., IoT-enabled systems) can optimize energy usage, reduce waste, and improve resource allocation. Automated lighting, heating, and cooling systems, alongside predictive maintenance for equipment, can lower energy consumption and maintenance costs over time.

3. Teaching and Learning Costs : Adopting online learning platforms and learning management systems (LMS) can reduce the need for physical classroom space and allow for scalability in teaching. Using e-learning tools, recorded lectures, and digital materials reduces the reliance on in-person instruction while providing flexibility and access to a wider range of educational content. This can help optimize the use of faculty time and resources.

HR Questions :

Tell me about yourself ?

Why do you want to join Capgemini ?

Which stocks are you currently invested in (based on CV and TMAY)?

B. A. Hons. (Psychology) | Workex – 30 months

Tell me about yourself ?

Why MBA after Psychology? Follow-up situational questions from the answer.

Cases:

1. Automobile case and GTM strategy with market entry and product development as focus (asked to forget the framework and maximise profit from a business perspective)

First, I would analyse the Indian Automotive industry including current trends, consumer preferences, competitive dynamics, demand shifts, etc. Then I would gauge the size of the market by segmenting the market on basis of geography, income, age and propensity to change vehicles under each income bracket. Based on my understanding of the industry, I believe our TG should be urban professionals and young aspirational buyers and we should launch an electric SUV.

(Cross-questions to check industry awareness)

Product development focus would be on safety features, smart technology integration and sustainability.

Go-to-market strategy: Positioned as sustainable luxury, penetrative pricing, financing avenues, and partnership with ride-sharing or cab service platforms would ensure maximum sales and profits.

2. Pricing strategy for the product designed – why penetrative and discuss all other options

Started with industry insights about competition in India and discusses the Target Group in detail. Value-based pricing and cost-based pricing can be used to do a sanity check, but these would not give us maximum profits in the Indian market.

What are your strengths and weaknesses?

What sets you apart from the rest of the batch? (They gave an answer first and asked me to validate or contradict)

What will you do as a marketing consultant when demand is higher than supply? How will you keep yourself relevant?

Do you have any questions for us?

B. Tech. (Civil) | Workex – 0 months

Tell me about yourself, your hobbies and interests.

Explain one of your projects in detail.

Why Not Try UPSC Again?

Why MBA Over Other Courses?

What role do you want and are you interested in a General Management/Strategy role.

Hand Sanitizer Product Discussion: (The interviewer picked up the hand sanitizer from the table)

What is this?

Would it be profitable to sell hand sanitizers?

This is a hand sanitizer, a product designed to get rid of harmful germs on the hands, particularly when soap and water are not available. Given the rise in awareness of hygiene due to the COVID-19 pandemic, the demand for hand sanitizers has surged significantly, so I believe it would be profitable. New distribution channels and more awareness for skincare products in youth would help too.

How would you launch a hand sanitizer product and what extra features would you add to differentiate it.

Name the product and give it a price based on the hand sanitizer already on the table. Suggest features you would add to make it unique in the market.

To launch a new sanitizer, I would start off with some research around its usage, consumer behaviour, pricing and features of existing brands. More importantly, I would look into consumer pain points and complaints from available products and capitalize on them. How handwash was introduced in India with very robust marketing around handwash and not particular brands, I would aim to create not just a want for using sanitizers, but a need. While developing the product, we would focus on how to make it pleasant to use, differentiating from competition. It would not leave your hands dry and rough, it would not smell like a medicine, among other things. It would also be more efficient in killing germs. The product category can be pushed as a whole and then focus can be brought to our product and brand.

I would name it CareShield+ to evoke the sense of safety and care. To price the product, I think competitive-pricing suits the best, since it is a limited differentiated market. From my understanding and knowledge about the product here, it is priced at around a 100-120 Rupees for a 100ml bottle. We can price ours at a slightly lower 110. It is not a lot but would make a difference during buying decision in the Indian market.

Interviewer pointed at the ceiling fan and asked:

Do you know the price of this product. What are some brands that you know and how will you distinguish your product from them?

I would estimate it based on similar products in the market, which typically range from around ₹2,000 to ₹5,000 for standard ceiling fans, depending on features and design. Fans from brands like Havells and Crompton are priced between ₹2,000 and ₹17,000 based on specifications, design and technology. Looking at the current market scenario, I would opt for a smart ceiling fan. This choice aligns with current trends in home automation and energy efficiency. Smart fans can be controlled via smartphone apps or voice assistants, so it is convenient as well as fancy.

To make it unique, we can look at features like energy efficiency using Brushless DC motor, integration with smart home systems, customizable lighting, noise reduction, sustainable materials and sleek aesthetic.

Our company is based in Delhi. Would you be willing to relocate? We don't see a strong reason for you to relocate from your home.

BS-MS, Biology/Biological Sciences | Workex – 0 months

Walk me through your CV.

Why did you decide to do an MBA when the most probable choice would have been PhD in your case.

When you worked on your project, did you face any issues or conflicts with your colleague or supervisor?

What do you think is most important in resolving conflicts?

What is your definition of a leader? What are the important qualities for a leader?

Do you have a vision for your future? What is it?

Why do you want to join Reliance?

What do you think are the pain points of the Reliance Smart store that you mentioned? (Some cross-questioning in this)

Which domain do you want to work in?

Why marketing?

Any questions for us?

B.Tech (Mechanical Engineering) | Workex – 27 months in Energy Sector

Why do you want to join Schneider Electric?

Having gained valuable experience working on several brownfield projects, I am eager to contribute to a greenfield project, which offers a broader scope for innovation and a more significant impact. Schneider Electric, renowned for its leadership in energy management and automation, stands at the forefront of innovation in this domain. Joining Schneider Electric would provide an exciting opportunity to work on pioneering greenfield projects early in my career, aligning perfectly with my aspirations. The role offered aligns seamlessly with my skills and career goals, making Schneider Electric the ideal choice for the next phase of my professional journey.

What insights do you have about the energy and power sector in India?

I am not deeply familiar with the power sector, but I have gained some insights through my cousin, who works in a power generation firm, giving me exposure to the industry's dynamics. India's energy sector predominantly relies on coal due to its cost-effectiveness and availability. However, this dependency presents significant sustainability challenges. To address these, the government has implemented initiatives to promote a transition towards greener energy solutions. Despite these efforts, the sector faces constraints such as the high upfront costs of renewable energy infrastructure, the intermittency of renewables like solar and wind, and the substantial investments required for grid upgrades and energy storage technologies. As a result, coal remains an essential component in meeting the country's immediate energy demands while the shift toward a sustainable future progresses.

Could you elaborate on the preventive and predictive maintenance activities you managed in your previous role?

I was actively involved in implementing preventive and predictive maintenance strategies to optimize operations and minimize downtime. Preventive activities included routine inspections and servicing of essential equipment such as pumps and pipelines, as well as ensuring the integrity of storage tanks through regular cleaning and thickness assessments. On the predictive side, I utilized advanced technologies like vibration analysis and thermographic imaging to monitor the condition of rotating machinery, enabling the early detection of potential issues and ensuring proactive resolution.

How has your approach to problem-solving evolved after pursuing an MBA, and how would you handle the same job differently now compared to before?

Before pursuing an MBA, my problem-solving approach was primarily intuitive, emphasizing immediate solutions and heavily relying on my technical expertise and prior experiences. However, the MBA experience has profoundly transformed my approach, introducing me to structured frameworks and enhancing my strategic thinking capabilities. I now tackle challenges with a more comprehensive perspective, integrating data-driven analysis, evaluating long-term implications, and considering diverse factors to develop well-rounded, impactful solutions.

In which domain do you see yourself working after 5 years?

In the next five years, I envision myself working in the strategy domain. This field excites me because it demands a holistic understanding of various industries and enables me to address a wide range of challenges. It perfectly aligns with my diverse skill set and background, providing the opportunity to leverage my experience to make informed, data-driven decisions that contribute to organizational growth and success. The dynamic nature of strategy allows me to use my strengths in problem-solving and innovation to create meaningful impact.

What are your short-term and long-term plans?

B.Tech Workex – 0 months	B.Tech (Computer Science) Workex – 10 months
What draws you to dystopian novels?	Why TAS ?
I find it inspiring to see a character holding onto hope in a world dominated by hopelessness, despair, and tyranny. In moments when I feel overwhelmed or helpless, these stories provide me with the strength to persevere and keep moving forward.	TAS offers an unparalleled opportunity for learning and growth by providing exposure to diverse sectors and industries. Its unique structure allows individuals to work on challenging projects across multiple Tata companies, fostering a holistic understanding of business dynamics. This diversity not only accelerates professional growth but also nurtures a versatile skill set, enabling adaptability in an ever-evolving business landscape.
Is there a gap in your extracurricular activities after school?	Additionally, the emphasis on leadership development, coupled with mentoring from industry stalwarts, makes TAS a perfect platform for aspiring leaders. The chance to contribute meaningfully to impactful projects while being part of an organization that values innovation and sustainability aligns perfectly with my career aspirations.
I chose to prioritize academics, which is reflected in my undergraduate scores. I also wanted to focus on other aspects of my personal development, so I reduced the time I dedicated to extracurricular activities. However, I am now eager to re-engage and take on more extracurricular opportunities moving forward.	Can you share your experiences and learnings from your internships?
Which Tata company would you like to join through the Tata Administrative Services (TAS)?	Other HR questions :
I aspire to join Croma. Before joining FMS, I had an unforgettable shopping experience at one of their stores, which left a lasting impression on me. Since that day, I've wanted to be on the other side, helping provide that exceptional experience to millions of customers.	Your Favorite Subject in MBA ?
	Questions on Projects mentioned in CV ?
	How do you deal with setbacks in life?
	When was the last time you apologized, and what was the reason?

B.Tech (Mechanical) | Workex – 18 months

Tell us about yourself. Walk us through your CV.

Talked about my background, College experience, PoRs, WorkEx, interests etc. Talked about my background, College experience, PoRs, WorkEx, interests etc.

Why TAS? (A lot of cross questioning on this)

Talked about their values, opportunity to work in different sectors, leadership program and emotional connection etc.

What new interests did you develop after you went to college?

Discussed interacting with people and sharing ideas etc.

Since, you told us you like to share ideas and interact with people, is there any unique idea you came up with?

Tell me 1 macro-economic and micro-economic factor which affects banking industry that you resonate with and why? (FSC project on banking sector)

Talked about business cycle (recession, boom etc) as macro factors, competitors as micro-factor.

Since, you talked about competitors. Suppose tata decides to open a bank, how will you solve this challenge?

Answered about improving CASA ratio, by offering higher interest rates initially and then will work on customer service improvements to prevent them from switching.

What specific customer service improvements will you work on?

What is your biggest success and why?

What is your favourite TATA company and which strategy of theirs you didn't like?

Discussed Titan and talked about the personal connect that I have with the brand, and appreciated durability of their watches. Said that I don't like that Titan watches since they do not usually have a casual big dial and non-sparkly watch segment for women.

During the GD round, which case did you like the most and why and what was the conclusion you reached?

Okay, if I talked to one of your friends, how will they describe you in three sentences?

How easy is it for you to take difficult talk?

I said I do find it difficult to say no to my friends etc.

If I am a new employee, how will you fire me?

What motivates you?

Talked about how I want to learn and evolve continuously and not be stagnant at one particular place.

Anything you would like to share with us which is not there in your CV?

Talked about an idea I was working on during my college days.

BBA, (IPM) IIM Indore | Workex – 0 months

Is this your first interview or have you rejected other companies for TAS?

Give us a short intro about yourself.

Mentioned undergraduate internships hobbies, two months internship experience at Alvarez and Marsal.

What was your role in Alvarez and Marsal? What were your responsibilities? What was the project and what was your personal contribution to the project?

It was an FMCG business, and we were trying to help them optimize their profits, we were looking for revenue and cost drivers to help them grow.

If you had an FMCG business. What would be your strategy and drivers for growth?

My primary strategy for growth would be centered around consumer needs, data-driven insights, and market dynamics. The primary drivers for growth would be innovative product development, market expansion, and a vast and robust distribution network.

What were your learnings from the project?

The recommendations that you gave to the client, were they any good? Were they useful for the client? And what else could you have focused on?

What were the limitations of the team that you were working in?

What was your FSC project about?

What are your hobbies?

What does success mean to you?

What gets going in life?

B. A. (Hons.), M.A. (Philosophy) | Workex – 0 months

Detailed discussion on Statement of Purpose submitted under application.

Tell us about your personal, academic and career journey.

You have a gap of 4 years for UPSC preparation. A lot of unconventional academic decisions along with it. Why? What brings you to an MBA after a Masters in Philosophy? (A lot of cross-questioning and back and forth on this)

Case: Suppose the Tata Group wants to build a business in the UPSC preparation landscape. How would you go about it? Just give a brief outline and vision.

After a thorough research to understand the market, I would propose developing a Unique Selling Proposition and establish a clear value that we want to deliver. In my opinion, it should be focused on realistic, achievable learning and guidance rather than selling "the dream".

Then, we will need to choose a business model: Online, offline, hybrid. Looking at recent controversies surrounding Byju's, we will need to have an offline presence to build confidence and stronger student community meanwhile expanding online customer base to popularize our offerings. A comprehensive curriculum and experienced faculty can also be our focus points. High-quality would be the priority.

Once the product is detailed out, we will look at strategies to enter in the market, and to build a sustainable ecosystem of education around the main courses offered. We can incorporate concepts like scholarships and grants to aid economically backwards sections too.

What do you bring to the table that makes you stand apart from your peers?

B.Tech (Computer Science) | Workex – 0 months**Tell me about yourself ?**

Gave my prepared answer covering my undergraduate studies, professional internships, and personal interests, presenting a holistic perspective using frameworks like STAR .

Other HR Questions :**What are your expectations from the General Management role at Hero FinCorp, and how do you see it aligning with your career aspirations?**

I expect to gain exposure to multiple business domains, with a focus on finance, which is central to my career aspirations. I look forward to honing my leadership skills, contributing to operational growth, and making data-driven decisions that will help the company achieve its objectives while advancing my understanding of financial strategies

Tell me something about yourself that is not in your resume ?**What are some of the KPI's that can be used to track customer engagement****Discussion on POR's and Summer Internship**

B.Tech (Electronics and Computer engineering) | Workex – 0 months

What is the meaning of your name?	What do you think of Elon musk's contribution to the industry? What are your opinions on Tesla?
Explain the spikes that you have mentioned on your CV.	Why do you want to join Mahindra? How does Mahindra fit the Vala your career goals?
What is your educational background? Why did you do a B. Tech and not anything else?	What do you think about industry 4.0?
Why do you want to do an MBA?	
Why did you come to FMS? What other calls did you have, and why did you not go to those colleges?	
Tell us about the internships that you have done.	
What are the different tools and technologies that you have worked on? What are some other technologies that you know about?	
Explain us the projects that you have done. What were the real world impact of the projects that you have done before coming to FMS?	
Tell us about your sports journey. Why have you picked that particular sport? What's going on recently in this sport.	
What are your academic achievements and how do you think they have shaped you?	
What PORs did you have in college? What initiatives did you start? What were your duties? Why did you choose this particular position of responsibility here at FMS?	
What are your hobbies and interests in tech? What are some recent happenings in the industry? Do you follow any YouTube or podcast/blogs related to tech?	
What is AI, ML, what are different ML models? What is the difference between AI, ML and deep learning? What are neural networks? What are convolution neural networks?	
So you have mentioned that you worked on a project based on NFTs and Blockchain, so what are some recent developments in this field and what are your opinions on it?	

B.Tech (Computer Science) | Workex – 12 months

Tell me about yourself ?

Why did you leave your full-time job ?

What motivated you to pursue an MBA?

What inspired you to choose finance as your major?

Why Aviation ?

What are some of the challenges and opportunities that you see in civil aviation ?

Can you suggest some Marketing Strategy improvements ?

Part G – Supplementary Content

[Main Index](#)

What?

- The Competitive Profile Matrix (CPM) identifies a firm's major competitors and its particular strengths and weaknesses in relation to a sample firm's strategic position.
- However, critical success factors in a CPM include both internal and external issues; therefore, the ratings refer to strengths and weaknesses, where 4 = major strength, 3 = minor strength, 2 = minor weakness, and 1 = major weakness.
- In a CPM, the ratings and total weighted scores for rival firms can be compared to the sample firm. This comparative analysis provides important internal strategic information.

When?

- Can be used in Pricing-related cases where there is a need to bring objectivity to come at a price for a product/service.
- Weights are assigned as per client requirements and preferences regarding the respective critical success factors
- Is also used to benchmark or compare multiple companies/products/services with each other basis different parameters, while also providing a holistic view of the entire picture

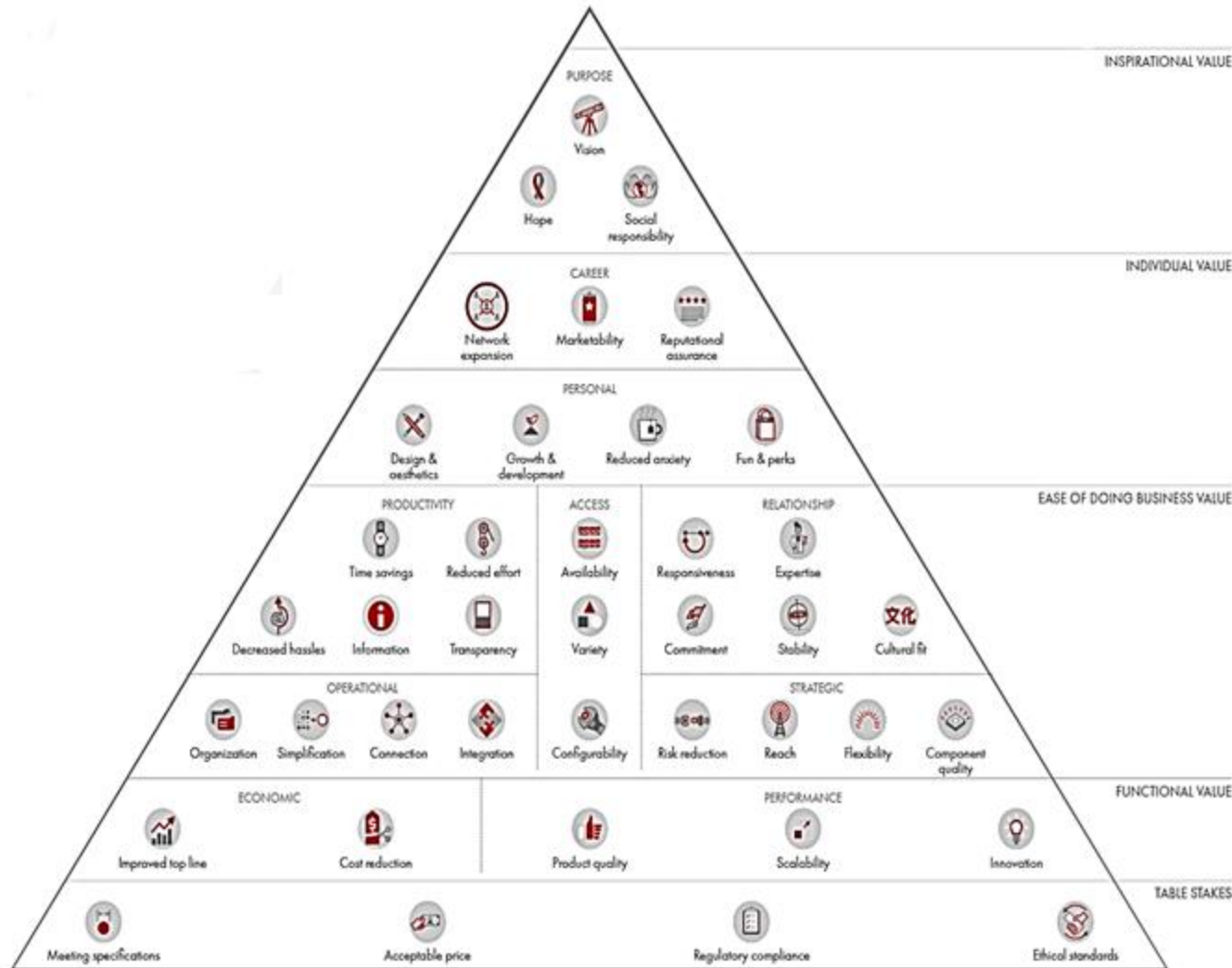
How?

Critical Success Factors	Company 1			Company 2		Company 3	
	Weight	Rating	Weighted Score	Rating	Weighted Score	Rating	Weighted Score
Market share	0.15	3	0.45	2	0.30	4	0.60
Inventory system	0.08	2	0.16	2	0.16	4	0.32
Financial position	0.10	2	0.20	3	0.30	4	0.40
Product quality	0.08	3	0.24	4	0.32	3	0.24
Consumer loyalty	0.02	3	0.06	3	0.06	4	0.08
Sales distribution	0.10	3	0.30	2	0.20	3	0.30
Global expansion	0.15	3	0.45	2	0.30	4	0.60
Organization structure	0.05	3	0.15	4	0.20	2	0.10
Production capacity	0.04	3	0.12	2	0.08	4	0.16
E-commerce	0.10	3	0.30	1	0.10	4	0.40
Customer service	0.10	3	0.30	2	0.20	4	0.40
Price competitive	0.02	4	0.08	1	0.02	3	0.06
Management experience	0.01	2	0.02	4	0.04	2	0.02
Total	1.00		2.83		2.28		3.68

An adaption of this matrix can be used by replacing different companies/competitors with the different choices a client faces with respect to his strategies. The critical success factors in this case would be dependent on what determines the success of the strategy in question.

B2B Elements of Value

The model sorts elements of value for a B2B business into the levels of a pyramid, with those providing more objective value at the base and those that offer more subjective value higher up

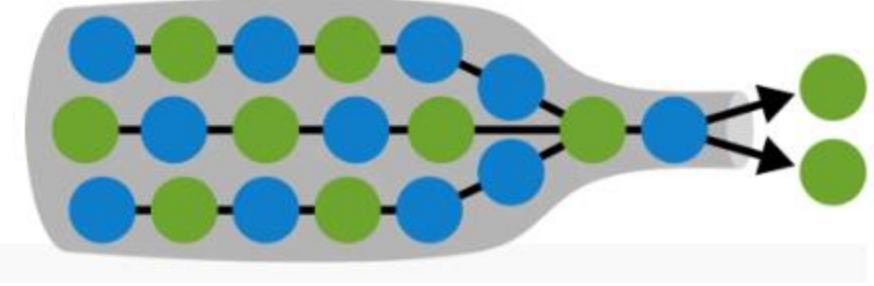


Use these elements in your frameworks to determine what matters the most to your client for his GTM strategy, or to detect where the bottlenecks lie when evaluating his current strategy.

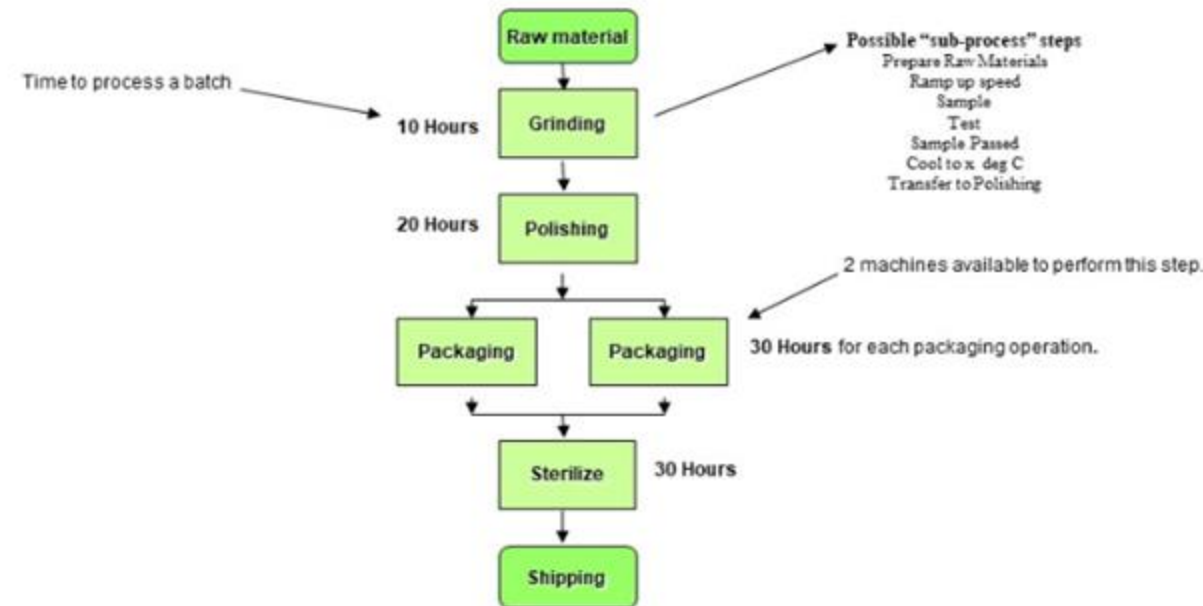
* Most can be extended/adapted for B2C businesses too

What?

- A bottleneck is any area along the production line where work can get backed up for one reason or another.
- Performing a bottleneck analysis can help to identify the cause of a bottleneck, and lead to potential solutions to get work flowing at a more even rate.
- In Bottleneck Analysis we are seeking to understand imbalances within a process, which cause delays, inventory build-up's, process stoppages.
- Ideally, we want a smooth continuous, even process flow, however, in reality process input flows can at times exceed the throughput capability of a process.



An Example



The Consulting Club
Faculty of Management Studies
Professor N.D. Kapoor Marg
Delhi University – 110007
www.fms.edu



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